ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR RESTAURANT TEAMS

# Restaurant Serving English

Clear orders. Confident service.



## Phil Stilwell

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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

# Your route through the book


## 01 Confirming seats and order details, page 4

Attach each dish and modifier to the correct guest, then read back the order before sending it.

## 02 Explaining menu choices and prices, page 14

Explain a supplement, calculate comparable menu prices, and leave the purchase choice with the guest.

## 03 Receiving an allergy question, page 26

Receive a reported allergy, ask the kitchen a precise question, and communicate unresolved ingredient and preparation information.

## 04 Coordinating courses and delays, page 36

Explain a kitchen estimate against a guest departure time without converting readiness into a guaranteed meal completion.

## 05 Correcting a dish without blame, page 48

Acknowledge an order mismatch, offer a specific remedy, and separate replacement timing from a bill-adjustment decision.

## 06 Explaining and splitting a bill, page 58

Clarify equal payments versus item-based checks, state the arithmetic, and confirm the method before processing payment.

## 07 Agreeing on clearing and shared service, page 70

Check permission to clear specific items and coordinate shared service without inferring that an empty plate is finished.

## 08 Handing over a live section, page 80

Give a concise table-by-table handover that separates meal stage, payment status, and an unresolved charge query.

Professional communication notes, page 3

Three additional workplace cases, page 94

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

# Warm service. Precise details.

Good service depends on listening closely while several things happen at once. Move between friendly guest-facing language and concise kitchen messages. Keep the table, seat, dish, request, timing, and responsible person clear.

## Ask one useful question

A short clarification can prevent a long correction. Repeat the exact detail that is unclear and ask the guest to attach it to a person or dish. Do not turn an unidentified modifier into a table-wide instruction.
"Which dish should have no onions?"

## Translate kitchen shorthand

Colleagues may say fire, covers, or on the fly. Guests need a clear explanation of their meal. Use internal shorthand only when the listener understands its local meaning.
"The kitchen estimates another eight minutes for your mains."

## Show the complete comparison

A set price and an individual dish price are not interchangeable. Name what each includes before describing the difference. A supplement increases the stated base; it is not a replacement price.
"The steak set is $29 with dessert; steak alone is $27 without dessert."

## Own the next step

An apology is more useful when followed by a specific action within your authority. Separate a replacement offer from an approved bill adjustment, and transfer live queries to a named colleague.
"I can offer the remake; the shift lead needs to review any bill adjustment."

> ### Professional boundaries
>
> All restaurants, prices, guests, and service events are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not food-safety certification, medical advice, or payment compliance. Follow current local law and actual allergy, food-handling, payment, and emergency procedures. Menu descriptions do not establish allergen safety. Do not delay urgent help for a routine service conversation.

# A Read the situation

**LESSON 01 / CONFIRMING SEATS AND ORDER DETAILS**

Attach each dish and modifier to the correct guest, then read back the order before sending it.

> **Who asked for no onions?**
>
> At fictional table 12, three guests are ordering. Seat one wants mushroom pasta; seat two wants salad with dressing separately; seat three has not chosen. Someone says "no onions," but server Lena cannot tell which dish the request belongs to. She has not sent the order. Guest Sam at seat two confirms that the onion request belongs to the salad. The dialogue follows Lena and section lead Cam checking that clarified request before transmission. Seat three still needs time. No allergy is reported in this case, and the onion request must not be treated as a confirmed allergy or a rule for every dish.

People: Lena, Server; Cam, Section lead.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. Which seat has not chosen?**

**A.** Seat two
**B.** All three seats
**C.** Seat three
**D.** Seat one

**2. Which request already belongs to the salad?**

**A.** Dressing mixed through the salad
**B.** Dressing separately
**C.** No mushrooms in the pasta
**D.** A completed third main

**3. What did Lena need to clarify when she first heard the request?**

**A.** Which dish should have dressing mixed in
**B.** Whether seat three had ordered pasta
**C.** Whether seat one wanted a different main
**D.** Which dish should have no onions

Answers and explanations, page 106

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### cover
One diner counted for restaurant service or planning.

*serve three covers*

### table number
Identifier used to locate a dining table.

*check the table number*

### point of sale
System for entering orders and recording sales, often abbreviated POS.

*enter the order at the point of sale*

### modifier
Instruction changing an item from its standard preparation or presentation.

*attach a modifier*

### substitution
Replacement of one component with another when available and permitted.

*check a substitution*

### read-back
Spoken repetition of recorded details to check accuracy.

*give a read-back*

### seat number
Identifier linking an order to a place at a table.

*confirm the seat number*

### order pad
Written surface used to record guest orders.

*update the order pad*

### order ticket
Record of dishes and instructions sent for preparation.

*read the order ticket*

### omission
Requested removal of an ingredient or component.

*confirm the omission*

### on the side
Served separately rather than mixed into or placed on the dish.

*serve dressing on the side*

### seat reference
Link showing which guest a detail concerns.

*clarify the seat reference*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**cover** COVER

serve three covers

Keep the meaning precise: One diner counted for restaurant service or planning.

**order ticket** ORDER TICKET

read the order ticket

Keep the meaning precise: Record of dishes and instructions sent for preparation.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### course
Stage of a meal, such as a starter or main.

*enter the main course*

### main
Principal dish in a meal.

*choose a main*

### starter
Dish served before the main course in the relevant menu format.

*order a starter*

### garnish
Item added to finish or accompany a dish.

*identify the garnish*

### accompaniment
Food served alongside a principal item.

*describe the accompaniment*

### preparation request
Guest instruction about how an item should be prepared.

*confirm the preparation request*

### dietary requirement
Food-related need that must be described accurately and handled appropriately.

*clarify a dietary requirement*

### preference
Stated choice that must not automatically be labeled a medical condition.

*record a preference*

### pending choice
Selection that has not yet been made.

*keep a choice pending*

### send the order
Transmit a confirmed order through the restaurant's system.

*send the order*

### order sequence
Agreed order in which information or dishes are handled.

*preserve the order sequence*

### confirmation
Explicit agreement that repeated details are correct.

*obtain confirmation*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**seat reference** SEAT REFERENCE

clarify the seat reference

Keep the meaning precise: Link showing which guest a detail concerns.

**accompaniment** ACCOMPANIMENT

describe the accompaniment

Keep the meaning precise: Food served alongside a principal item.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Clarify the dish**
Which dish should have no onions?

**Check the guest**
Is that request for your salad?

**Read back seat one**
Seat one is the mushroom pasta.

**Read back seat two**
Seat two is the salad with dressing on the side.

**Preserve the pending choice**
Seat three is still deciding.

**Attach the modifier**
I have noted no onions for your salad.

**Avoid a table-wide change**
I will not apply that request to the other dishes.

**Ask briefly**
May I check one detail before I send this?

**Translate separately**
You would like the dressing served separately, correct?

**Separate request and guarantee**
I will confirm any preparation question through our kitchen process.

**Keep the record aligned**
The seat reference and modifier need to stay together.

**Avoid an invented allergy**
No allergy has been reported in this exchange.

**Confirm understanding**
Have I matched the dishes and requests correctly?

**Allow time**
I will give seat three another moment to choose.

**Keep transmission accurate**
The order has not been sent yet.

**Close with the corrected detail**
Salad for seat two, no onions, dressing on the side.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Read back seat two
**Useful wording:** Seat two is the salad with dressing on the side.

**Purpose:** Preserve the pending choice
**Useful wording:** Seat three is still deciding.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which clarification is most useful?**

**A.** Which dish should have no onions?
**B.** Shall I put no onions on the whole table?
**C.** Is the pasta the one with both changes?
**D.** Should I send three portions of pasta?

**2. What should be sent as the salad modifier after Sam confirms?**

**A.** No mushrooms in every dish
**B.** Dressing mixed through all dishes
**C.** Cancel seat three's meal
**D.** No onions, dressing on the side

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Written surface used to record guest orders. Which term fits?**

**A.** starter
**B.** pending choice
**C.** substitution
**D.** order pad

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Who asked for no onions?". Lena: "Mushroom pasta, unchanged. Seat three was still looking at the menu when I came over, so I have left that choice open." Cam: [missing response] Lena: "I will go back to that guest. Before I do, can you repeat what you have? I want to catch any mismatch now." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Keep it as a pending choice, then. Do not copy the pasta into the third seat just to fill the space.

**B.** Good. The order ticket needs the same dish-and-seat links. A general no-onions note across the table would give the kitchen a different instruction.

**C.** Now the seat reference makes the connection clear. Keep the requests attached to that item in the system too.

**D.** Here is the read-back: table twelve, seat one mushroom pasta; seat two salad, no onions, dressing on the side; seat three still deciding.

Answers and explanations, page 106

### One useful distinction

No onions needs a clear dish reference. Do not attach it to every plate because the speaker was unclear. A modifier describes the requested change; a reported allergy requires its own accurate communication and the actual allergy process.

# E Conversation

## Who asked for no onions?

Who asked for no onions?

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

modifier / seat reference / send the order / order ticket / confirmation / on the side / covers / read-back / pending choice / omission

01 **Lena:** Cam, can you check table twelve with me before I send it? Three guests, two mains chosen. I clarified the onion request with Sam at seat two.

02 **Cam:** Yes. Which dish gets the [1] _____? Your first note says no onions between the two mains, so I cannot tell which one it follows.

03 **Lena:** It belongs to the salad, not the pasta. Sam also wants the dressing separately. I have corrected the note against seat two.

04 **Cam:** Salad, no onions, dressing [2] _____. That is clear. What is seat one having?

05 **Lena:** Mushroom pasta, unchanged. Seat three was still looking at the menu when I came over, so I have left that choice open.

06 **Cam:** Keep it as a [3] _____, then. Do not copy the pasta into the third seat just to fill the space.

07 **Lena:** I will go back to that guest. Before I do, can you repeat what you have? I want to catch any mismatch now.

08 **Cam:** Here is the [4] _____: table twelve, seat one mushroom pasta; seat two salad, no onions, dressing on the side; seat three still deciding.

09 **Lena:** Correct. The salad has both requests. I originally wrote them between the items because two people were speaking at once.

10 **Cam:** Now the [5] _____ makes the connection clear. Keep the requests attached to that item in the system too.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Who asked for no onions?

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Lena:** I have not sent anything yet. I wanted to settle the unclear detail first rather than ask the kitchen to interpret my note.

12 **Cam:** Good. The [6] _____ needs the same dish-and-seat links. A general no-onions note across the table would give the kitchen a different instruction.

13 **Lena:** The screen shows three diners, but only two main dishes so far. That is why the totals do not match yet.

14 **Cam:** Three [7] _____, two confirmed mains. That is fine while the last person is choosing. The diner count does not supply a missing order.

15 **Lena:** Sam said no onions, but did not report an allergy. I repeated the request and confirmed the dish rather than guessing the reason.

16 **Cam:** Record the [8] _____ accurately. If an allergy is reported, use our allergy procedure; do not treat an ordinary modifier as a substitute for that process.

17 **Lena:** I will return to seat three now and ask what they would like. Then I can repeat the complete order to the table.

18 **Cam:** Get that last [9] _____ from the guest. Leave Sam's salad request as it is unless Sam changes it.

19 **Lena:** Understood: pasta unchanged, salad with its two requests, third main still open. I will come back if the guest needs a kitchen check.

20 **Cam:** All right. Follow our process when you [10] _____. Keep the dish, seat, and instructions together so the kitchen receives what the guests actually asked for.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** modifier / **2.** on the side / **3.** pending choice / **4.** read-back / **5.** seat reference / **6.** order ticket / **7.** covers / **8.** omission / **9.** confirmation / **10.** send the order

Why these answers fit, page 107

# F Check accuracy and scope

## Who asked for no onions?

### Return to the case

At fictional table 12, three guests are ordering. Seat one wants mushroom pasta; seat two wants salad with dressing separately; seat three has not chosen. Someone says "no onions," but server Lena cannot tell which dish the request belongs to. She has not sent the order. Guest Sam at seat two confirms that the onion request belongs to the salad. The dialogue follows Lena and section lead Cam checking that clarified request before transmission. Seat three still needs time. No allergy is reported in this case, and the onion request must not be treated as a confirmed allergy or a rule for every dish.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. Which statement preserves the pending choice?**

**A.** Seat three ordered mushroom pasta.
**B.** Seat three is not eating.
**C.** All three mains are confirmed.
**D.** Seat three is still deciding.

**2. What does the onion request establish medically?**

**A.** No allergy diagnosis or report by itself
**B.** A confirmed onion allergy for all diners
**C.** That no allergy process is ever needed
**D.** That all foods are safe

Answers and explanations, page 108

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Say the final read-back without changing the pasta or inventing the third main.

### Clarification is part of attention

A guest may speak while another person is ordering, or answer on behalf of someone else. A brief, neutral check avoids blame and keeps the exchange moving. Say which detail needs clarification rather than asking the whole table to repeat everything.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Attach a different request

Table 8 has two covers. Seat one orders tomato soup; seat two orders grilled fish. A lemon-separately request is clarified as belonging to the fish. No third diner or allergy is reported.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

unchanged / fish / two / covers

01 **Server:** The lemon request belongs to the [1] _____.

02 **Guest:** That is seat [2] _____.

03 **Server:** The tomato soup remains [3] _____.

04 **Guest:** There are two [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** fish / **2.** two / **3.** unchanged / **4.** covers

Why these answers fit, page 109

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Who asked for no onions?". Lena: "The screen shows three diners, but only two main dishes so far. That is why the totals do not match yet." Cam: [missing response] Lena: "Sam said no onions, but did not report an allergy. I repeated the request and confirmed the dish rather than guessing the reason." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Three covers, two confirmed mains. That is fine while the last person is choosing. The diner count does not supply a missing order.

**B.** Good. The order ticket needs the same dish-and-seat links. A general no-onions note across the table would give the kitchen a different instruction.

**C.** Here is the read-back: table twelve, seat one mushroom pasta; seat two salad, no onions, dressing on the side; seat three still deciding.

**D.** Yes. Which dish gets the modifier? Your first note says no onions between the two mains, so I cannot tell which one it follows.

Answers and explanations, page 110

# A Read the situation

**LESSON 02 / EXPLAINING MENU CHOICES AND PRICES**

Explain a supplement, calculate comparable menu prices, and leave the purchase choice with the guest.

> **The steak set or steak alone?**
>
> The fictional lunch set is $24 and includes a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds a $5 supplement to that set price. The a la carte steak is $27 without dessert. Both steak options include potatoes. Guest Jordan initially thinks the steak set must cost $24, then wonders whether potatoes cost extra. Server Priya must compare the $29 steak set with the $27 steak alone, explain the two-dollar difference, and avoid inventing a separate dessert price, drink inclusion, or tax policy. No choice has been made at the start.

People: Jordan, Lunch guest; Priya, Server.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. What is the steak set price?**

**A.** $24
**B.** $27
**C.** $32
**D.** $29

**2. Which item is included in both steak options?**

**A.** A separate starter
**B.** Potatoes
**C.** Dessert
**D.** Coffee

**3. What is not supplied?**

**A.** The set base price
**B.** The steak supplement
**C.** The a la carte steak price
**D.** A separate dessert price

Answers and explanations, page 111

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### set menu
Group of included courses offered for a stated price, subject to listed conditions.

*explain the set menu*

### a la carte
Ordered as individual menu items rather than as a set.

*order a la carte*

### supplement
Additional charge added to a stated base price.

*apply the steak supplement*

### base price
Starting price before specified additions.

*state the base price*

### inclusive price
Price covering the items or charges explicitly named as included.

*explain the inclusive price*

### inclusion
Item or service covered by the quoted option.

*compare the inclusions*

### exclusion
Item or charge not covered by an option.

*clarify an exclusion*

### price difference
Amount separating two prices on a comparable basis.

*calculate the price difference*

### standalone price
Price charged for an item bought separately.

*verify the standalone price*

### upgrade
Change to a different or enhanced option, often at an added cost.

*explain the upgrade*

### main-and-dessert set
Meal option combining a main course and dessert.

*choose the main-and-dessert set*

### side dish
Food served alongside a principal dish.

*include a side dish*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**set menu** SET MENU

explain the set menu

Keep the meaning precise: Group of included courses offered for a stated price, subject to listed conditions.

**inclusion** INCLUSION

compare the inclusions

Keep the meaning precise: Item or service covered by the quoted option.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

### portion

Amount served to one person or as specified.

*describe the portion*

### menu description

Written account of a dish or offer.

*read the menu description*

### daily special

Dish or offer identified as special for the relevant service period.

*explain the daily special*

### availability

Whether an item can currently be ordered.

*check availability*

### value comparison

Assessment of price alongside the contents or benefits of an option.

*make a value comparison*

### additional charge

Amount payable beyond a specified quoted price.

*identify an additional charge*

### price clarification

Explanation resolving uncertainty about what an amount means.

*give a price clarification*

### itemized total

Sum showing the individual components that make up the charge.

*present an itemized total*

### optional extra

Additional item that is not compulsory or automatically included.

*describe an optional extra*

### menu pairing

Combination of items offered or suggested together.

*explain the menu pairing*

### price basis

Items and conditions to which a quoted price applies.

*state the price basis*

### guest choice

Selection made by the diner after receiving relevant information.

*confirm the guest choice*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**side dish** SIDE DISH

include a side dish

Keep the meaning precise: Food served alongside a principal dish.

**value comparison** VALUE COMPARISON

make a value comparison

Keep the meaning precise: Assessment of price alongside the contents or benefits of an option.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Introduce the set**
The lunch set includes a main and dessert.

**Explain the addition**
Steak carries a $5 supplement on that set.

**Introduce the alternative**
The a la carte steak is $27.

**Keep shared inclusions clear**
Both steak options include potatoes.

**Avoid an unsupported standalone price**
That difference is not a quoted separate dessert price.

**Do not invent a surcharge**
No extra potato charge is listed in these options.

**Avoid pressure**
It depends on whether you want the included dessert.

**Confirm the chosen option**
Let me confirm which option you would like.

**State the base**
The set starts at $24.

**Give the combined price**
That makes the steak set $29.

**Name the difference in contents**
The a la carte option does not include dessert.

**Calculate the difference**
The set is two dollars more than steak alone.

**Respond to a price misunderstanding**
The $24 is the base, before the steak supplement.

**Keep the choice open**
Would you prefer the set with dessert or the steak alone?

**Separate unknown details**
I would need to check any detail not stated on this menu.

**Summarize evenly**
$29 with dessert, or $27 without dessert; potatoes are included in both.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Give the combined price
**Useful wording:** That makes the steak set $29.

**Purpose:** Introduce the alternative
**Useful wording:** The a la carte steak is $27.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which calculation is correct?**

**A.** $27 - $24 = $3 for dessert

**B.** $24 + $5 = $29 for the steak set

**C.** $27 + $5 = $32 for the steak set

**D.** $24 - $5 = $19 for the steak set

**2. Which comparison is complete?**

**A.** $24 versus $27 with identical inclusions

**B.** $29 without potatoes versus $27 with potatoes

**C.** $5 versus $27 for the entire meal

**D.** $29 with dessert versus $27 without dessert; both include potatoes.

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Starting price before specified additions. Which term fits?**

**A.** daily special

**B.** base price

**C.** optional extra

**D.** standalone price

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "I also see steak listed separately at twenty-seven. Is that another way of ordering the same main without taking the lunch set?" Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Good, I was about to ask about the potatoes. I do not want to discover I need to order a side as well." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Of course. A useful value comparison depends on what you want to eat. The more expensive option is not automatically the better choice for you.

**B.** Yes, that is the a la carte option. The steak is twenty-seven without dessert. Both options include potatoes, so you do not need to add them to this comparison.

**C.** Certainly. I will wait for your guest choice. When you are ready, tell me set or a la carte, and I will confirm the option before entering it.

**D.** I would need to check the standalone price before quoting that. The two-dollar comparison does not mean every separately ordered dessert has a two-dollar price.

Answers and explanations, page 111

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The $5 supplement belongs to the $24 set base: $24 + $5 = $29. It is not added to the $27 a la carte price. The comparison is $29 with dessert versus $27 without dessert, with potatoes in both.

# E Conversation

## The steak set or steak alone?

The steak set or steak alone?

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

value comparison / base price / a la carte / standalone price / price difference / inclusion / main-and-dessert set / price basis / supplement / guest choice

01 **Jordan:** Could you help me with the lunch menu? I saw twenty-four dollars beside the set, but there is another amount beside the steak.

02 **Priya:** Certainly. Twenty-four dollars is the [1] _____ for a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds five dollars, so that particular set comes to twenty-nine.

03 **Jordan:** So the steak is five dollars extra on the set? I first read that as a separate price, which did not seem right.

04 **Priya:** Exactly. It is a [2] _____ to the set. Twenty-four plus five is twenty-nine for the steak set, including dessert.

05 **Jordan:** I also see steak listed separately at twenty-seven. Is that another way of ordering the same main without taking the lunch set?

06 **Priya:** Yes, that is the [3] _____ option. The steak is twenty-seven without dessert. Both options include potatoes, so you do not need to add them to this comparison.

07 **Jordan:** Good, I was about to ask about the potatoes. I do not want to discover I need to order a side as well.

08 **Priya:** Potatoes are a shared [4] _____ here. The difference stated on this menu is the dessert, alongside the two different menu prices.

09 **Jordan:** Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert.

10 **Priya:** That is the correct [5] _____. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# The steak set or steak alone?

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Jordan:** Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?

12 **Priya:** I would need to check the [6] _____ before quoting that. The two-dollar comparison does not mean every separately ordered dessert has a two-dollar price.

13 **Jordan:** That makes sense. I may not want dessert after the steak. Could you give me a moment to choose?

14 **Priya:** Of course. A useful [7] _____ depends on what you want to eat. The more expensive option is not automatically the better choice for you.

15 **Jordan:** Is coffee included with the dessert in that set? I sometimes see that elsewhere, but I cannot find it in this description.

16 **Priya:** Coffee is not part of the stated [8] _____ in the details we are comparing. I would check its price and status separately rather than tell you it is part of the set.

17 **Jordan:** Thanks. I will leave coffee for now. Could you repeat just the two steak prices for me?

18 **Priya:** Then the [9] _____ is twenty-nine for steak, potatoes, and the included dessert, or twenty-seven for steak and potatoes without dessert.

19 **Jordan:** Let me check with my friend about dessert before I decide. I have not chosen the set yet.

20 **Priya:** Certainly. I will wait for your [10] _____. When you are ready, tell me set or a la carte, and I will confirm the option before entering it.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** base price / **2.** supplement / **3.** a la carte / **4.** inclusion / **5.** price difference / **6.** standalone price / **7.** value comparison / **8.** main-and-dessert set / **9.** price basis / **10.** guest choice

Why these answers fit, page 112

# F Check accuracy and scope

## The steak set or steak alone?

### Return to the case

The fictional lunch set is $24 and includes a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds a $5 supplement to that set price. The a la carte steak is $27 without dessert. Both steak options include potatoes. Guest Jordan initially thinks the steak set must cost $24, then wonders whether potatoes cost extra. Server Priya must compare the $29 steak set with the $27 steak alone, explain the two-dollar difference, and avoid inventing a separate dessert price, drink inclusion, or tax policy. No choice has been made at the start.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. What cannot be inferred from the two-dollar difference?**

**A.** Both steak options include potatoes.
**B.** The restaurant's standalone dessert price is $2.
**C.** The steak set costs $2 more.
**D.** The set includes dessert.

**2. Which recommendation avoids pressure?**

**A.** The set includes coffee as well as dessert.
**B.** If you want dessert, the set includes it for two dollars more than steak alone.
**C.** The set saves five dollars compared with steak alone.
**D.** You can add any dessert later for two dollars.

Answers and explanations, page 114

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Repeat the final comparison, keeping potatoes in both options and dessert in the set only.

### Help the guest compare

A recommendation should explain a relevant difference without pressuring the guest or implying a more expensive option is always better. State the total for each option and its inclusions. Let the guest decide whether the added item is worth the difference.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Compare another set

A fictional main-and-dessert set has a $20 base and a $4 fish supplement. Fish alone costs $22 without dessert. Both options include rice. No separate dessert price is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

twenty-four / rice / unspecified / twenty-two

01 **Server:** The fish set costs [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Guest:** Fish alone is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Server:** Both options include [3] _____.

04 **Guest:** The separate dessert price is [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** twenty-four / **2.** twenty-two / **3.** rice / **4.** unspecified

Why these answers fit, page 114

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "That makes sense. I may not want dessert after the steak. Could you give me a moment to choose?" Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Is coffee included with the dessert in that set? I sometimes see that elsewhere, but I cannot find it in this description." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Certainly. Twenty-four dollars is the base price for a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds five dollars, so that particular set comes to twenty-nine.

**B.** Of course. A useful value comparison depends on what you want to eat. The more expensive option is not automatically the better choice for you.

**C.** I would need to check the standalone price before quoting that. The two-dollar comparison does not mean every separately ordered dessert has a two-dollar price.

**D.** That is the correct price difference. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.

Answers and explanations, page 115

# Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Confirming seats and order details" and "Explaining menu choices and prices". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

**1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Identifier used to locate a dining table. Which term fits?**

**A.** preference
**B.** omission
**C.** main
**D.** table number

**2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Amount separating two prices on a comparable basis. Which term fits?**

**A.** set menu
**B.** portion
**C.** price clarification
**D.** price difference

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "Who asked for no onions?". Lena: "Correct. The salad has both requests. I originally wrote them between the items because two people were speaking at once." Cam: [missing response] Lena: "I have not sent anything yet. I wanted to settle the unclear detail first rather than ask the kitchen to interpret my note." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Salad, no onions, dressing on the side. That is clear. What is seat one having?
**B.** Keep it as a pending choice, then. Do not copy the pasta into the third seat just to fill the space.
**C.** Now the seat reference makes the connection clear. Keep the requests attached to that item in the system too.
**D.** Get that last confirmation from the guest. Leave Sam's salad request as it is unless Sam changes it.

# Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "Thanks. I will leave coffee for now. Could you repeat just the two steak prices for me?" Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Let me check with my friend about dessert before I decide. I have not chosen the set yet." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Then the price basis is twenty-nine for steak, potatoes, and the included dessert, or twenty-seven for steak and potatoes without dessert.

**B.** Potatoes are a shared inclusion here. The difference stated on this menu is the dessert, alongside the two different menu prices.

**C.** That is the correct price difference. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.

**D.** Exactly. It is a supplement to the set. Twenty-four plus five is twenty-nine for the steak set, including dessert.

Answers and explanations, page 146

# A Read the situation

**LESSON 03 / RECEIVING AN ALLERGY QUESTION**

Receive a reported allergy, ask the kitchen a precise question, and communicate unresolved ingredient and preparation information.

> **Checking the bun before ordering**
>
> At table 6, guest Eli reports a sesame allergy and asks whether the burger bun is suitable. Server Noor has an old menu description, not current ingredient or cross-contact information. Kitchen lead Cam is available to discuss the question before any order is sent. The conversation does not supply a verified bun ingredient list, a confirmed preparation arrangement, or a safe alternative. Noor must preserve the reported allergen, check the current product and handling information through the real allergy procedure, and avoid replacing an unanswered question with reassurance.

People: Eli, Guest reporting a sesame allergy; Noor, Server.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. Which allergen does Eli report?**

**A.** An unspecified dislike
**B.** A confirmed milk allergy
**C.** A general dislike of bread
**D.** Sesame

**2. What information does Noor hold?**

**A.** An old menu description
**B.** A verified current bun specification
**C.** A confirmed cross-contact assessment
**D.** A guaranteed safe alternative

**3. Who is available before an order is sent?**

**A.** Only a future supplier next month
**B.** No responsible colleague
**C.** Another diner making a guess
**D.** Kitchen lead Cam

Answers and explanations, page 116

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### food allergy
Immune-system reaction to a food protein that can be serious.

*report a food allergy*

### allergen
Substance capable of causing an allergic reaction in a susceptible person.

*identify the allergen*

### sesame
Seed recognized among the major food allergens in the United States.

*flag a sesame allergy*

### ingredient list
Record of substances intentionally used in a product.

*check the current ingredient list*

### product specification
Detailed information describing a particular supplied food product.

*verify the product specification*

### supplier label
Label information attached to or associated with a supplied product.

*inspect the supplier label*

### recipe
Specified ingredients and method for making a dish.

*check the current recipe*

### cross-contact
Unintended introduction of an allergen into another food.

*assess allergen cross-contact*

### shared equipment
Equipment used for more than one food or preparation.

*check shared equipment*

### preparation area
Place where food is handled or assembled.

*verify the preparation area*

### allergen matrix
Structured record showing allergen information across relevant menu items.

*consult the current allergen matrix*

### current product
Actual product presently used, which may differ from an older description.

*identify the current product*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**food allergy** FOOD ALLERGY

report a food allergy

Keep the meaning precise: Immune-system reaction to a food protein that can be serious.

**supplier label** SUPPLIER LABEL

inspect the supplier label

Keep the meaning precise: Label information attached to or associated with a supplied product.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### recipe change

Alteration to a dish's ingredients or method.

*verify a recipe change*

### product substitution

Use of a different supplied item in place of the usual one.

*check for a product substitution*

### allergy flag

Clear system marker identifying a reported allergy for the relevant order.

*enter an allergy flag*

### kitchen lead

Responsible kitchen colleague coordinating the relevant preparation question.

*consult the kitchen lead*

### order hold

Pause before progressing an order while a necessary matter is resolved.

*maintain the order hold*

### ingredient verification

Check of the ingredients in the actual relevant product.

*complete ingredient verification*

### handling information

Details about how food is stored, prepared, and served.

*obtain handling information*

### unsupported assurance

Reassuring claim without adequate information or authority.

*avoid an unsupported assurance*

### reported allergen

Substance the guest identifies as the source of an allergy.

*repeat the reported allergen*

### alternative dish

Different menu item that still requires appropriate checks for the guest.

*check an alternative dish*

### allergic reaction

Response to an allergen that may require urgent medical attention.

*follow allergic-reaction procedures*

### emergency response

Immediate action through the applicable emergency arrangements.

*activate the emergency response*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**current product** CURRENT PRODUCT

identify the current product

Keep the meaning precise: Actual product presently used, which may differ from an older description.

**order hold** ORDER HOLD

maintain the order hold

Keep the meaning precise: Pause before progressing an order while a necessary matter is resolved.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Acknowledge the disclosure**

Thank you for telling me about the sesame allergy.

**State the information limit**

This old description does not verify today's bun.

**Name the next person**

I will speak with Cam, our kitchen lead.

**Ask about the record**

Can you verify its current ingredient information?

**Avoid appearance-based reassurance**

A plain surface does not establish the ingredients.

**Keep the guest informed**

The question is still being checked.

**Preserve the allergy flag**

The reported sesame allergy must stay linked to your order.

**Avoid unsupported certainty**

I cannot confirm suitability from the information available.

**Repeat the allergen**

I have heard sesame; is that correct?

**Pause the order**

I will check before sending an order.

**Ask about the actual product**

Which bun is being used for this service?

**Include handling**

We also need the relevant cross-contact information.

**Do not improvise a fix**

Removing visible seeds would not answer the safety question.

**Avoid a false alternative**

A different dish would need its own appropriate checks.

**Separate receipt and resolution**

Cam has received the question; it is not resolved yet.

**Return to the guest accurately**

I will explain the verified information and any remaining limits before you choose.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Pause the order
**Useful wording:** I will check before sending an order.

**Purpose:** Name the next person
**Useful wording:** I will speak with Cam, our kitchen lead.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which first response is best?**

**A.** Try a small bite first.

**B.** Thank you for telling me; I will check the current bun and handling information with Cam.

**C.** The bun looks plain, so it is safe.

**D.** Pick off any visible seeds.

**2. Which distinction matters?**

**A.** Receiving a question automatically resolves it.

**B.** Ingredients and cross-contact are separate questions.

**C.** A plain appearance proves no sesame.

**D.** An old menu is always current.

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Record of substances intentionally used in a product. Which term fits?**

**A.** shared equipment

**B.** reported allergen

**C.** allergy flag

**D.** ingredient list

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Checking the bun before ordering". Eli: "Please include how it is handled, not just the ingredients. I would rather wait for an accurate answer than have someone tell me it is probably fine." Noor: [missing response] Eli: "Have you been able to pass that question to Cam? I would like to know it has reached the person checking the kitchen information." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Thank you for telling me. I will repeat the reported allergen when I speak with the kitchen: sesame. Is that correct, and is the bun the item you want me to check?

**B.** Of course. I will ask about the ingredients and cross-contact. I cannot confirm suitability from this description, and I will not put the order through while that question is unresolved.

**C.** Certainly. The ingredient verification and preparation checks are not complete yet. I will keep their actual status clear rather than describe Cam receiving the question as a final answer.

**D.** Yes, Cam has received it. We need the current ingredient list for today's bun. That check has not been completed, so the old description is not our answer.

Answers and explanations, page 116

> **One useful distinction**
>
> A plain-looking bun is not an ingredient list. Ingredient information and cross-contact information answer related but different questions. Removing visible seeds does not establish suitability. An old menu description cannot certify the actual product being prepared today.

# E Conversation

## Checking the bun before ordering

Checking the bun before ordering

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

reported allergen / product specification / allergy flag / ingredient list / current product / alternative dish / ingredient verification / handling information / order hold / cross-contact

01 **Eli:** Before I order, I need to ask about the burger bun. I have a sesame allergy, and the picture does not tell me what is in the bread.

02 **Noor:** Thank you for telling me. I will repeat the [1] _____ when I speak with the kitchen: sesame. Is that correct, and is the bun the item you want me to check?

03 **Eli:** Yes, sesame, and I am asking about the bun first. I know some bread can contain it even without seeds on the surface.

04 **Noor:** I have only an old description here, not verified information for the [2] _____. I will check with Cam, our kitchen lead, before sending an order.

05 **Eli:** Please include how it is handled, not just the ingredients. I would rather wait for an accurate answer than have someone tell me it is probably fine.

06 **Noor:** Of course. I will ask about the ingredients and [3] _____. I cannot confirm suitability from this description, and I will not put the order through while that question is unresolved.

07 **Eli:** Have you been able to pass that question to Cam? I would like to know it has reached the person checking the kitchen information.

08 **Noor:** Yes, Cam has received it. We need the current [4] _____ for today's bun. That check has not been completed, so the old description is not our answer.

09 **Eli:** Good. Please ask about preparation as well. I have had to be careful with shared equipment at other restaurants.

10 **Noor:** Yes. The relevant [5] _____ still needs verification through our allergy procedure. I made clear that you are asking about both ingredients and preparation.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Checking the bun before ordering

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Eli:** Thank you. I also do not want anyone to remove visible seeds and assume that has answered the question. The bread itself matters.

12 **Noor:** Agreed. We need the actual [6] _____ and relevant supplier information. A plain surface or removal of visible seeds is not enough to establish suitability.

13 **Eli:** I will wait. Please do not bring me a different dish in the meantime; I need to choose after the check.

14 **Noor:** Understood. The [7] _____ remains in place. Any alternative would need its own appropriate checks and your agreement before we proceed.

15 **Eli:** Has the kitchen actually checked the bun yet, or are they still finding the information?

16 **Noor:** Certainly. The [8] _____ and preparation checks are not complete yet. I will keep their actual status clear rather than describe Cam receiving the question as a final answer.

17 **Eli:** If the bun does not work for me, could we discuss another option afterward? I have not picked one yet.

18 **Noor:** I will not. Any [9] _____ would need its own checks and your choice. Your order has not been sent.

19 **Eli:** That is fine. I will wait for the verified information before deciding. Please keep the sesame allergy attached to the discussion if someone else takes over.

20 **Noor:** Yes. The [10] _____ and the unresolved question must stay together. I will return with the information we can actually confirm and explain any remaining limits.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** reported allergen / **2.** current product / **3.** cross-contact / **4.** ingredient list / **5.** handling information / **6.** product specification / **7.** order hold / **8.** ingredient verification / **9.** alternative dish / **10.** allergy flag

Why these answers fit, page 117

# F Check accuracy and scope

## Checking the bun before ordering

### Return to the case

At table 6, guest Eli reports a sesame allergy and asks whether the burger bun is suitable. Server Noor has an old menu description, not current ingredient or cross-contact information. Kitchen lead Cam is available to discuss the question before any order is sent. The conversation does not supply a verified bun ingredient list, a confirmed preparation arrangement, or a safe alternative. Noor must preserve the reported allergen, check the current product and handling information through the real allergy procedure, and avoid replacing an unanswered question with reassurance.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. What does Cam's availability establish?**

**A.** A kitchen lead can discuss the query.
**B.** The bun has been certified suitable.
**C.** No allergy flag is needed.
**D.** A different dish is automatically safe.

**2. Which guest update is accurate?**

**A.** Every dish is safe for every allergy.
**B.** The old description is enough.
**C.** A reaction has occurred even though none is reported.
**D.** I cannot confirm suitability yet; the current information is being checked.

Answers and explanations, page 119

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Stress the difference between Cam receiving the question and completing the ingredient and handling checks.

### Take the disclosure seriously

Thank the guest for identifying the allergy and make the next step clear. Do not test whether the guest sounds serious enough or rely on how a product looks. The guest should hear what is known, what needs checking, and who is handling the question.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Receive a different allergen question

At table 9, guest Alex reports a peanut allergy and asks about a sauce. The server has an old description only. Kitchen lead Imani accepts the query. No ingredient or handling answer is yet verified.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

confirmed / Imani / peanut / sauce

01 **Server:** The reported allergen is [1] _____.

02 **Colleague:** The product being questioned is the [2] _____.

03 **Server:** The receiving kitchen lead is [3] _____.

04 **Colleague:** Suitability is not yet [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** peanut / **2.** sauce / **3.** Imani / **4.** confirmed

Why these answers fit, page 119

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Checking the bun before ordering". Eli: "I will wait. Please do not bring me a different dish in the meantime; I need to choose after the check." Noor: [missing response] Eli: "Has the kitchen actually checked the bun yet, or are they still finding the information?" Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Agreed. We need the actual product specification and relevant supplier information. A plain surface or removal of visible seeds is not enough to establish suitability.

**B.** Understood. The order hold remains in place. Any alternative would need its own appropriate checks and your agreement before we proceed.

**C.** Yes. The relevant handling information still needs verification through our allergy procedure. I made clear that you are asking about both ingredients and preparation.

**D.** I will not. Any alternative dish would need its own checks and your choice. Your order has not been sent.

Answers and explanations, page 120

# A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / COORDINATING COURSES AND DELAYS

Explain a kitchen estimate against a guest departure time without converting readiness into a guaranteed meal completion.

> **Eight more minutes?**
>
> Table 14 has finished its starters. The mains were fired at 7:20. At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes because one dish is still being prepared. The guests need to leave at 7:50. Server Tomas must explain the current estimate and offer a discussion about timing, while avoiding a promise that the mains will arrive exactly at 7:38 or that the guests can finish comfortably before departure. No cancellation, faster substitute, priority slot, or price adjustment has been approved in this case.

People: Tomas, Server; Riley, Guest at table 14.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. When were the mains fired?**

**A.** 7:30
**B.** 7:38 as a completed event
**C.** 7:50
**D.** 7:20

**2. What is the current estimate at 7:30?**

**A.** Guaranteed departure at 7:38
**B.** Another eight minutes
**C.** Eight minutes total since 7:20
**D.** Guaranteed service at 7:30

**3. What is the guests' departure requirement?**

**A.** Arrive at 7:50
**B.** Have the mains ready by 7:50
**C.** Leave at 7:50
**D.** Begin starters at 7:50

Answers and explanations, page 121

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### fire
Kitchen instruction to begin or advance preparation at the required service stage.

*fire the mains*

### pickup
Kitchen-to-service handoff when dishes are ready for collection.

*coordinate pickup*

### expeditor
Person coordinating dish completion and kitchen-to-floor delivery.

*check with the expeditor*

### ticket time
Elapsed time associated with an order ticket, measured from a specified event.

*check the ticket time*

### remaining time
Additional duration expected from the current update.

*state the remaining time*

### service window
Period available for serving or completing a specified service activity.

*discuss the service window*

### fired time
Recorded time when the relevant preparation instruction was given.

*confirm the fired time*

### pass
Kitchen area where finished dishes are checked and handed to service staff.

*collect from the pass*

### course pacing
Timing of successive stages of a meal.

*adjust course pacing*

### readiness estimate
Approximate expectation for when food will be ready at the stated stage.

*give a readiness estimate*

### departure deadline
Latest time by which guests need to leave.

*acknowledge the departure deadline*

### preparation stage
Current step in making a dish.

*confirm the preparation stage*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**fire** FIRE

fire the mains

Keep the meaning precise: Kitchen instruction to begin or advance preparation at the required service stage.

**course pacing** COURSE PACING

adjust course pacing

Keep the meaning precise: Timing of successive stages of a meal.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### table update

Information given to guests about their order or service.

*deliver a table update*

### bottleneck

Step limiting the progress of the overall process.

*identify the bottleneck*

### rush request

Request to accelerate work that still requires confirmation.

*check a rush request*

### on the fly

Urgent preparation request in restaurant shorthand, not a guarantee of instant service.

*request a dish on the fly*

### update point

Agreed occasion for communicating the next status.

*agree an update point*

### completion promise

Commitment that a stated outcome will occur by a defined time.

*avoid an unsupported completion promise*

### timing constraint

Limit that affects when something needs to occur.

*clarify the timing constraint*

### coordinated service

Arrangement for related dishes to reach guests in a planned sequence.

*arrange coordinated service*

### priority

Relative precedence given to a task under the actual service arrangement.

*confirm priority*

### elapsed time

Duration already passed between specified points.

*calculate elapsed time*

### timing discussion

Conversation about feasible options under a time constraint.

*offer a timing discussion*

### contingency

Alternative arrangement available if the intended plan cannot work.

*verify a contingency*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**preparation stage** PREPARATION STAGE

confirm the preparation stage

Keep the meaning precise: Current step in making a dish.

**rush request** RUSH REQUEST

check a rush request

Keep the meaning precise: Request to accelerate work that still requires confirmation.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Acknowledge the wait**

I am sorry your mains are taking longer than you expected.

**Name the remaining work**

One dish is still being prepared.

**Preserve the source**

This is the kitchen's current estimate.

**Avoid a false comfort claim**

I cannot promise that leaves enough time for your meal.

**Offer a discussion**

Let me discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.

**Clarify the clock**

The eight minutes is from the 7:30 update.

**Do not promise a substitute**

Any alternative timing needs to be checked.

**Do not dismiss the deadline**

Your departure time matters to the decision.

**Give the current update**

At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes.

**Translate the estimate**

That points to around 7:38, not a guaranteed service time.

**Repeat the constraint**

You need to leave at 7:50.

**Separate stages**

Kitchen readiness and arrival at the table are different stages.

**Avoid invented priority**

I cannot promise a faster slot before it is confirmed.

**Keep the earlier time clear**

The mains were fired at 7:20.

**Agree the next communication**

Let us agree when you will receive the next update.

**Close accurately**

The estimate is still provisional, and the timing options need discussion.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Translate the estimate
**Useful wording:** That points to around 7:38, not a guaranteed service time.

**Purpose:** Preserve the source
**Useful wording:** This is the kitchen's current estimate.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which timing explanation is accurate?**

**A.** The guests can definitely finish by 7:50.

**B.** At 7:30 the kitchen estimates eight more minutes, pointing to around 7:38.

**C.** The mains were served at 7:20.

**D.** Eight minutes from 7:20 guarantees service at 7:28.

**2. What does 7:50 minus 7:38 establish?**

**A.** A promise that payment is complete

**B.** A confirmed twelve-minute cooking time

**C.** That the guests can stay indefinitely

**D.** A twelve-minute clock interval, not guaranteed dining time

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Kitchen area where finished dishes are checked and handed to service staff. Which term fits?**

**A.** remaining time

**B.** update point

**C.** pass

**D.** bottleneck

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "When did they start preparing them? We are not upset with you, but we do need to know where we stand." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "All right. If they are ready around seven thirty-eight, that leaves twelve minutes before we have to go. That sounds rather tight for us." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Understood. My next table update should tell you what the kitchen can confirm and what remains uncertain. We should also agree when you will hear from me again.

**B.** We can have a timing discussion about that. I would need the kitchen to check any alternative; I do not have a confirmed substitute time to offer you now.

**C.** The fired time was seven twenty. In our kitchen language, that is when the mains were called for preparation. It does not mean they were ready or served then.

**D.** I am sorry about the wait. I have a current readiness estimate from the kitchen: at seven thirty, they expect another eight minutes. One dish is still being prepared.

Answers and explanations, page 121

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Eight more minutes at 7:30 points to approximately 7:38 for the stated readiness estimate. It is not eight minutes from 7:20. Readiness, delivery to the table, eating, payment, and departure are separate events.

# E Conversation

## Eight more minutes?

Eight more minutes?

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

departure deadline / Pickup / table update / fired time / completion promise / timing discussion / remaining time / timing constraint / rush request / readiness estimate

01 **Riley:** Could you check our mains, please? We have finished the starters, and we need to leave at seven fifty. I am beginning to worry about the time.

02 **Tomas:** I am sorry about the wait. I have a current [1] _____ from the kitchen: at seven thirty, they expect another eight minutes. One dish is still being prepared.

03 **Riley:** Another eight minutes from now? I thought the mains had gone in earlier. I am trying to work out whether we can stay.

04 **Tomas:** The [2] _____ is from the seven-thirty update. That points to around seven thirty-eight for the stated estimate, but I cannot guarantee arrival at that exact time.

05 **Riley:** When did they start preparing them? We are not upset with you, but we do need to know where we stand.

06 **Tomas:** The [3] _____ was seven twenty. In our kitchen language, that is when the mains were called for preparation. It does not mean they were ready or served then.

07 **Riley:** All right. If they are ready around seven thirty-eight, that leaves twelve minutes before we have to go. That sounds rather tight for us.

08 **Tomas:** I agree that your [4] _____ matters. The twelve minutes is only the difference between those times; it does not guarantee enough time to receive the food, eat, and settle the bill.

09 **Riley:** Can you move our order ahead of everyone else? I realize the kitchen is busy, but we cannot miss the event we are going to.

10 **Tomas:** I can discuss a [5] _____ with the kitchen. I cannot promise a different position or faster completion before they confirm what is actually possible.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Eight more minutes?

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Riley:** Would it be quicker to change one of the dishes? I do not want to cancel the whole meal if a realistic option is available.

12 **Tomas:** We can have a [6] _____ about that. I would need the kitchen to check any alternative; I do not have a confirmed substitute time to offer you now.

13 **Riley:** Please check. We would rather hear what is possible now than sit here hoping the food will arrive.

14 **Tomas:** Understood. My next [7] _____ should tell you what the kitchen can confirm and what remains uncertain. We should also agree when you will hear from me again.

15 **Riley:** Does that time mean ready in the kitchen or actually at our table? We will still need time to eat and pay.

16 **Tomas:** Correct. [8] _____ and delivery to the table are separate from the cooking estimate. I will clarify which stage the estimate covers when I speak with the kitchen.

17 **Riley:** Thank you. We still need to leave at seven fifty, even if the food is delayed. That is the constraint we need you to work with.

18 **Tomas:** I will carry that [9] _____ into the conversation. I will not represent your departure as flexible or assume you can stay longer.

19 **Riley:** Thank you. Please check before changing anything. We still have the original order for now.

20 **Tomas:** Agreed. I will avoid a [10] _____ I cannot support. Your order status, the current estimate, and any decision we make next will stay clear.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** readiness estimate / **2.** remaining time / **3.** fired time / **4.** departure deadline / **5.** rush request / **6.** timing discussion / **7.** table update / **8.** Pickup / **9.** timing constraint / **10.** completion promise

Why these answers fit, page 122

# F Check accuracy and scope

## Eight more minutes?

### Return to the case

Table 14 has finished its starters. The mains were fired at 7:20. At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes because one dish is still being prepared. The guests need to leave at 7:50. Server Tomas must explain the current estimate and offer a discussion about timing, while avoiding a promise that the mains will arrive exactly at 7:38 or that the guests can finish comfortably before departure. No cancellation, faster substitute, priority slot, or price adjustment has been approved in this case.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. Which offer stays within the facts?**

**A.** I can discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.
**B.** I guarantee a replacement in two minutes.
**C.** The bill is already canceled.
**D.** Your table has automatically received top priority.

**2. Which phrase needs translation for a guest?**

**A.** The current estimate is eight more minutes.
**B.** Your mains were fired at 7:20.
**C.** You need to leave at 7:50.
**D.** One dish is still being prepared.

Answers and explanations, page 124

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Repeat the readiness explanation without promising table arrival or enough time to eat.

### Tell the guest what the clock actually means

Internal timing can sound like a promise when repeated without context. Translate preparation status into guest-facing language, acknowledge the departure constraint, and check realistic options. Do not hide uncertainty behind kitchen jargon or assume the guest has enough time to eat.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Anchor a new estimate

At 8:10, the kitchen estimates six more minutes for a dish. The guests need to leave at 8:30. No faster alternative or guaranteed table-delivery time has been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

8:30 / 8:16 / unconfirmed / 8:10

01 **Server:** The estimate starts from [1] _____.

02 **Guest:** That points to around [2] _____.

03 **Server:** Your departure requirement is [3] _____.

04 **Guest:** A faster alternative remains [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** 8:10 / **2.** 8:16 / **3.** 8:30 / **4.** unconfirmed

Why these answers fit, page 124

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "Please check. We would rather hear what is possible now than sit here hoping the food will arrive." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "Does that time mean ready in the kitchen or actually at our table? We will still need time to eat and pay." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Understood. My next table update should tell you what the kitchen can confirm and what remains uncertain. We should also agree when you will hear from me again.

**B.** I am sorry about the wait. I have a current readiness estimate from the kitchen: at seven thirty, they expect another eight minutes. One dish is still being prepared.

**C.** The remaining time is from the seven-thirty update. That points to around seven thirty-eight for the stated estimate, but I cannot guarantee arrival at that exact time.

**D.** The fired time was seven twenty. In our kitchen language, that is when the mains were called for preparation. It does not mean they were ready or served then.

Answers and explanations, page 125

# Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Receiving an allergy question" and "Coordinating courses and delays". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

**1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Seed recognized among the major food allergens in the United States. Which term fits?**

**A.** sesame

**B.** cross-contact

**C.** product substitution

**D.** unsupported assurance

**2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Approximate expectation for when food will be ready at the stated stage. Which term fits?**

**A.** table update

**B.** fire

**C.** readiness estimate

**D.** on the fly

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert." Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?" Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Potatoes are a shared inclusion here. The difference stated on this menu is the dessert, alongside the two different menu prices.

**B.** That is the correct price difference. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.

**C.** Certainly. Twenty-four dollars is the base price for a main and dessert. Choosing steak adds five dollars, so that particular set comes to twenty-nine.

**D.** I would need to check the standalone price before quoting that. The two-dollar comparison does not mean every separately ordered dessert has a two-dollar price.

# Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "Thank you. We still need to leave at seven fifty, even if the food is delayed. That is the constraint we need you to work with." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "Thank you. Please check before changing anything. We still have the original order for now." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** I will carry that timing constraint into the conversation. I will not represent your departure as flexible or assume you can stay longer.

**B.** I can discuss a rush request with the kitchen. I cannot promise a different position or faster completion before they confirm what is actually possible.

**C.** The remaining time is from the seven-thirty update. That points to around seven thirty-eight for the stated estimate, but I cannot guarantee arrival at that exact time.

**D.** Agreed. I will avoid a completion promise I cannot support. Your order status, the current estimate, and any decision we make next will stay clear.

Answers and explanations, page 148

# A Read the situation

**LESSON 05 / CORRECTING A DISH WITHOUT BLAME**

Acknowledge an order mismatch, offer a specific remedy, and separate replacement timing from a bill-adjustment decision.

### Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

At table 3, guest Alex ordered vegetable pasta but received mushroom risotto. The ticket confirms vegetable pasta. Server Dana checks the mismatch and learns that the kitchen can remake the pasta with an estimated ten-minute wait. Dana may offer that replacement, but any bill adjustment requires shift lead review. The cause of the wrong delivery is not established. No allergy is reported. Alex has not accepted the remake at the start, and neither compensation nor a guaranteed ten-minute arrival has been approved.

People: Alex, Guest at table 3; Dana, Server.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. What does the ticket confirm?**

**A.** A canceled order
**B.** Vegetable pasta
**C.** Mushroom risotto
**D.** Two identical risottos

**2. What replacement can Dana offer?**

**A.** A completed refund
**B.** A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait
**C.** A guaranteed two-minute steak
**D.** An automatic free meal

**3. Who must review a bill adjustment?**

**A.** An unnamed supplier
**B.** The shift lead
**C.** Any guest at a nearby table
**D.** Dana automatically without review

Answers and explanations, page 126

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### order mismatch
Difference between what was ordered and what was delivered or recorded.

*acknowledge the order mismatch*

### replacement offer
Proposed substitute or corrected item that the guest may accept.

*explain the replacement offer*

### apology
Direct expression of regret for an error or inconvenience.

*offer a clear apology*

### ticket check
Review of the order record to establish what was entered.

*perform a ticket check*

### ordered dish
Food the guest requested.

*confirm the ordered dish*

### cause
Reason an error occurred, which may require further investigation.

*avoid guessing the cause*

### remake
Newly prepared replacement for a dish that needs correction.

*request a remake*

### service recovery
Actions addressing a service failure and its effect on the guest.

*manage service recovery*

### inconvenience
Practical difficulty or disruption caused to the guest.

*acknowledge the inconvenience*

### delivered dish
Food actually brought to the guest.

*identify the delivered dish*

### confirmed mismatch
Discrepancy established by the available record and observation.

*state the confirmed mismatch*

### blame
Attribution of fault to a person or group.

*avoid unsupported blame*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**order mismatch** ORDER MISMATCH

acknowledge the order mismatch

Keep the meaning precise: Difference between what was ordered and what was delivered or recorded.

**inconvenience** INCONVENIENCE

acknowledge the inconvenience

Keep the meaning precise: Practical difficulty or disruption caused to the guest.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### remedy
Action intended to put a problem right.

*offer an available remedy*

### acceptance
Agreement to a proposed option.

*confirm acceptance*

### comp
Informal restaurant term for an item provided without charge under authorization.

*obtain approval for a comp*

### refund
Return of money already paid.

*process an approved refund*

### shift lead
Person coordinating service decisions during a shift.

*consult the shift lead*

### resolution status
Whether the proposed correction has actually been agreed and completed.

*confirm the resolution status*

### estimated wait
Approximate expected delay before a specified next event.

*explain the estimated wait*

### bill adjustment
Authorized change to an amount on the guest's bill.

*request a bill adjustment*

### discount
Reduction from a stated price.

*authorize a discount*

### void
Cancellation of a transaction or entry through the relevant system procedure.

*record an authorized void*

### approval limit
Boundary on the decisions someone may authorize.

*observe an approval limit*

### follow-up check
Later confirmation that the corrective action occurred and met the stated need.

*make a follow-up check*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**blame** BLAME

avoid unsupported blame

Keep the meaning precise: Attribution of fault to a person or group.

**comp** COMP

obtain approval for a comp

Keep the meaning precise: Informal restaurant term for an item provided without charge under authorization.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Acknowledge the mismatch**

You ordered vegetable pasta, and we brought mushroom risotto.

**Apologize directly**

I am sorry; that is not the dish you ordered.

**Refer to the record**

I checked the ticket, and it confirms the pasta.

**Avoid blaming the guest**

You do not need to explain the order again.

**Offer the actual remedy**

The kitchen can remake the vegetable pasta.

**State the estimated wait**

The current estimate is ten minutes.

**Ask for acceptance**

Would you like that replacement?

**Keep timing honest**

I cannot guarantee an exact arrival time.

**Avoid guessing fault**

I have not established how the mismatch happened.

**Address the practical effect**

I understand that the extra wait affects your meal.

**Separate the financial question**

Any bill adjustment needs the shift lead's review.

**Do not promise an unauthorized comp**

I cannot confirm a free item before approval.

**Name the next action**

I will bring the bill question to the shift lead.

**Keep consent clear**

I will wait for your go-ahead before arranging the replacement.

**Check completion later**

I will confirm that the correct dish reaches you.

**Confirm the next step**

I will check the bill question first, then come back for your decision.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Avoid blaming the guest
**Useful wording:** You do not need to explain the order again.

**Purpose:** Offer the actual remedy
**Useful wording:** The kitchen can remake the vegetable pasta.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which apology fits the facts?**

**A.** I am sorry; the ticket confirms pasta, but we brought risotto.

**B.** I am sorry; your order was entered as risotto.

**C.** I am sorry; the kitchen has confirmed who took the wrong plate.

**D.** I am sorry; I have already removed the charge.

**2. Which offer is authorized?**

**A.** A guaranteed ten-minute arrival and free meal

**B.** A refund already completed

**C.** Any replacement at any price with no check

**D.** A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Actions addressing a service failure and its effect on the guest. Which term fits?**

**A.** shift lead

**B.** acceptance

**C.** ordered dish

**D.** service recovery

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Pasta ordered, risotto delivered". Alex: "Is that ten minutes from now? We have already waited for the first round, so I need a realistic idea before I decide." Dana: [missing response] Alex: "Will there be anything off the bill? I do not feel comfortable paying as though everything arrived correctly." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** They have quoted an estimated wait of ten minutes. I cannot promise the exact arrival time, and I understand another wait disrupts your meal.

**B.** I can ask for a bill adjustment. Our shift lead needs to review that; I can offer the replacement but cannot approve the charge change myself.

**C.** That is right. I cannot promise it will be complimentary before the lead decides. I will explain both the wrong dish and the additional wait.

**D.** The ticket is correct. I do not yet know the cause of the delivery error. I can acknowledge it without guessing which colleague made it.

Answers and explanations, page 126

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The ticket confirms pasta, so the server can acknowledge the mismatch without guessing its cause. The kitchen offers a remake; the guest still needs to accept it. An available remedy is not the same as a completed resolution.

# E Conversation

## Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

mistake / complimentary / shift lead / estimated wait / bill adjustment / remake / cause / check back / next step / go-ahead

01 **Alex:** Excuse me, this is mushroom risotto. I ordered vegetable pasta. Could you check? Everyone else has their main, and I do not want to start the wrong dish.

02 **Dana:** I am sorry about the [1] _____. The ticket says vegetable pasta. We brought you something different.

03 **Alex:** Can I still get the pasta? I had been looking forward to it, but I am worried the others will finish before mine arrives.

04 **Dana:** The kitchen can make a [2] _____. Their current estimate is ten minutes. Would you like me to arrange that?

05 **Alex:** Is that ten minutes from now? We have already waited for the first round, so I need a realistic idea before I decide.

06 **Dana:** They have quoted an [3] _____ of ten minutes. I cannot promise the exact arrival time, and I understand another wait disrupts your meal.

07 **Alex:** Will there be anything off the bill? I do not feel comfortable paying as though everything arrived correctly.

08 **Dana:** I can ask for a [4] _____. Our shift lead needs to review that; I can offer the replacement but cannot approve the charge change myself.

09 **Alex:** I thought the replacement might be free. Are you saying you cannot promise that yet?

10 **Dana:** That is right. I cannot promise it will be [5] _____ before the lead decides. I will explain both the wrong dish and the additional wait.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Alex:** Was the order entered incorrectly? I heard you say the ticket has pasta on it.

12 **Dana:** The ticket is correct. I do not yet know the [6] _____ of the delivery error. I can acknowledge it without guessing which colleague made it.

13 **Alex:** If I do take the pasta, will you make sure it is mine this time? I would rather not go through this again.

14 **Dana:** Yes. I will [7] _____ on the corrected dish and keep you updated if the kitchen's timing changes.

15 **Alex:** Before I decide, could you speak to the lead about the bill? Please do not start the replacement yet.

16 **Dana:** Understood. I will wait for your [8] _____. Hearing the offer is not the same as agreeing to it.

17 **Alex:** Thank you. Can the lead speak with me if there are questions? I would prefer to explain what the extra wait means for us.

18 **Dana:** I will pass that request to the [9] _____, along with the ticket, what arrived, and the ten-minute estimate.

19 **Alex:** All right. For now, please check the bill question. Then I will decide whether to wait for the pasta.

20 **Dana:** That is our [10] _____. I am sorry your meal has been interrupted. I will return with the decision rather than leave you wondering what is happening.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** mistake / **2.** remake / **3.** estimated wait / **4.** bill adjustment / **5.** complimentary / **6.** cause / **7.** check back / **8.** go-ahead / **9.** shift lead / **10.** next step

Why these answers fit, page 127

# F Check accuracy and scope

## Pasta ordered, risotto delivered

### Return to the case

At table 3, guest Alex ordered vegetable pasta but received mushroom risotto. The ticket confirms vegetable pasta. Server Dana checks the mismatch and learns that the kitchen can remake the pasta with an estimated ten-minute wait. Dana may offer that replacement, but any bill adjustment requires shift lead review. The cause of the wrong delivery is not established. No allergy is reported. Alex has not accepted the remake at the start, and neither compensation nor a guaranteed ten-minute arrival has been approved.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. Which statement keeps the financial decision accurate?**

**A.** I will ask the shift lead to review the bill question.
**B.** I have already approved a comp.
**C.** Every remake legally requires a refund.
**D.** The kitchen estimate authorizes a discount.

**2. When can the issue be described as fully resolved?**

**A.** Before the guest accepts an offer
**B.** As soon as someone guesses the cause
**C.** After the relevant agreed actions are actually completed and checked
**D.** Immediately when an apology is spoken

Answers and explanations, page 129

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Keep Alex's go-ahead pending and the bill decision with the shift lead throughout.

### An apology can be direct

Name the mismatch without making the guest prove an error already confirmed by the ticket. Take responsibility for the next step without guessing which colleague caused the problem. A sincere apology does not require inventing a free meal or a guaranteed preparation time.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Offer a different correction

Table 7 ordered lentil soup but received tomato soup. The ticket confirms lentil soup. A remake is available with an estimated seven-minute wait. Lead Noor must review any bill adjustment.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

lentil / seven / tomato / Noor

01 **Server:** The ticket confirms [1] _____ soup.

02 **Guest:** The delivered soup was [2] _____.

03 **Server:** The estimated remake wait is [3] _____ minutes.

04 **Guest:** The bill question goes to [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** lentil / **2.** tomato / **3.** seven / **4.** Noor

Why these answers fit, page 129

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Pasta ordered, risotto delivered". Alex: "If I do take the pasta, will you make sure it is mine this time? I would rather not go through this again." Dana: [missing response] Alex: "Before I decide, could you speak to the lead about the bill? Please do not start the replacement yet." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** The kitchen can make a remake. Their current estimate is ten minutes. Would you like me to arrange that?

**B.** Yes. I will check back on the corrected dish and keep you updated if the kitchen's timing changes.

**C.** I will pass that request to the shift lead, along with the ticket, what arrived, and the ten-minute estimate.

**D.** Understood. I will wait for your go-ahead. Hearing the offer is not the same as agreeing to it.

Answers and explanations, page 130

# A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / EXPLAINING AND SPLITTING A BILL

Clarify equal payments versus item-based checks, state the arithmetic, and confirm the method before processing payment.

**What does three ways mean?**

Three diners have a fictional $72 bill, with all listed charges included. Guest Morgan asks to split it "three ways." The restaurant can arrange equal payments or separate checks by item before payment is processed. Server Jules must ask which method the diners mean. Equal shares would be $24 each; item-based shares cannot be calculated without the item allocation. No additional charge, tip decision, completed payment, or refund is supplied. Morgan later confirms that the group wants three equal payments, and Jules reads back that choice before processing.

People: Morgan, Guest speaking for the group; Jules, Server.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. What is the stated bill total?**

**A.** $72 with all listed charges included
**B.** $72 plus an invented charge
**C.** $24 for the entire table
**D.** An unknown total

**2. What does three ways need to clarify?**

**A.** Equal payments or separate checks by item
**B.** Whether there are three diners at all
**C.** Whether the meal happened yesterday
**D.** Whether every diner ordered identical food

**3. What is each equal share?**

**A.** $36
**B.** $18
**C.** $27
**D.** $24

Answers and explanations, page 131

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### check
Restaurant bill listing the guest's charges.
*bring the check*

### itemized bill
Bill showing individual items or charges.
*review the itemized bill*

### equal share
Same portion of the total assigned to each person.
*calculate an equal share*

### item allocation
Assignment of particular ordered items to particular payers.
*confirm the item allocation*

### allocation method
Agreed way of dividing the total or items.
*clarify the allocation method*

### listed charge
Amount explicitly shown on the bill.
*verify a listed charge*

### bill total
Amount due for the listed charges.
*confirm the bill total*

### split payment
Payment of one amount through multiple payments or payers.
*arrange a split payment*

### separate check
Individual bill assigned to a particular diner or group.
*prepare separate checks*

### shared item
Dish or charge used by more than one diner.
*allocate a shared item*

### subtotal
Sum before the specified additional components included in a final total.
*distinguish the subtotal*

### service charge
Charge imposed under the restaurant's stated terms, distinct from a discretionary tip.
*explain a service charge*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**check** CHECK

bring the check

Keep the meaning precise: Restaurant bill listing the guest's charges.

**separate check** SEPARATE CHECK

prepare separate checks

Keep the meaning precise: Individual bill assigned to a particular diner or group.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### gratuity
Usually a tip; an automatic mandatory charge may instead be a service charge under applicable rules.

*clarify a gratuity*

### card terminal
Device used to submit a card payment.

*present the card terminal*

### payment receipt
Record acknowledging the payment transaction.

*provide a payment receipt*

### partial payment
Payment of less than the full amount due.

*record a partial payment*

### rounding
Adjustment to an available monetary precision under the relevant method.

*explain rounding*

### reconciliation
Comparison of payments and amounts due to check that records agree.

*complete payment reconciliation*

### payment method
Means used to pay, such as a card or cash.

*confirm the payment method*

### authorization
Approval stage for a payment under the relevant payment system.

*check payment authorization*

### outstanding balance
Amount that remains unpaid.

*confirm the outstanding balance*

### payment confirmation
Evidence or acknowledgment that a payment was completed at the relevant stage.

*check payment confirmation*

### duplicate charge
Repeated charge for the same item or transaction where duplication is at issue.

*investigate a duplicate charge*

### settle the bill
Complete payment of the amount due.

*settle the bill*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**service charge** SERVICE CHARGE

explain a service charge

Keep the meaning precise: Charge imposed under the restaurant's stated terms, distinct from a discretionary tip.

**payment receipt** PAYMENT RECEIPT

provide a payment receipt

Keep the meaning precise: Record acknowledging the payment transaction.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Clarify the request**

Do you mean three equal payments or separate checks by item?

**Explain equal shares**

Three equal shares would be $24 each.

**Handle shared dishes**

How should the shared items be allocated?

**Check the timing**

We can arrange either method before processing payment.

**Read back the amount**

That is $24 for each of the three payments.

**Separate the tip decision**

Would you like to decide on any optional tip separately?

**Check the terminal amount**

Please check the amount before confirming the payment.

**Offer a receipt**

Would each person like their own payment receipt?

**State the total**

The bill total is $72.

**Explain the other method**

For item-based checks, I need to know which items belong to each person.

**Avoid a fairness assumption**

I will use the method your group agrees on.

**Confirm the selected method**

You would like three equal payments, correct?

**Do not invent an extra charge**

The stated total already includes all listed charges.

**Keep payment status factual**

The split is agreed, but no payment has been processed yet.

**Track what remains**

We need to record each actual payment against the balance.

**Close before processing**

Three equal payments of $24, against the $72 total.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Explain the other method
**Useful wording:** For item-based checks, I need to know which items belong to each person.

**Purpose:** Handle shared dishes
**Useful wording:** How should the shared items be allocated?

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which first question resolves the ambiguity?**

**A.** Three ways always means three unequal checks, right?

**B.** Do you mean equal payments or separate checks by item?

**C.** You all ate exactly the same amount, correct?

**D.** Shall I split only the food and leave the shared charges on one card?

**2. Which arithmetic is correct for equal shares?**

**A.** $72 divided by 3 is $36 each.

**B.** Three payments of $24 leave $24 unpaid.

**C.** Three payments of $72 equal the original bill.

**D.** $72 divided by 3 is $24 each.

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Payment of one amount through multiple payments or payers. Which term fits?**

**A.** allocation method

**B.** rounding

**C.** split payment

**D.** card terminal

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "If someone wants to pay only for their own meal, can you do that too? We would need to sort out the shared starters." Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "We did share some food, so equal payments may be simpler for us. Let me confirm with the others before you enter anything." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** The bill total is seventy-two dollars. Divided equally among three people, that is twenty-four dollars each. Those three amounts add back to seventy-two.

**B.** Yes. The outstanding balance must reflect the actual payments recorded. Three agreed amounts are not a substitute for checking which transactions have completed.

**C.** Exactly. We will obtain payment confirmation through the actual process. Three equal payments of twenty-four dollars is the instruction I am working from.

**D.** Yes. That requires an item allocation. We would also need your agreement about shared items rather than assume an equal division of those.

Answers and explanations, page 131

**One useful distinction**

Three equal shares of $72 are $24 each. That arithmetic does not show what each diner consumed. Separate checks by item need an agreed allocation, including shared items, before amounts can be determined.

# E Conversation

## What does three ways mean?

What does three ways mean?

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

item allocation / payment confirmation / allocation method / listed charge / outstanding balance / payment receipt / split payment / bill total / card terminal / equal shares

01 **Morgan:** Could we split this three ways, please? There are three of us, and we would like to sort it out before everyone starts reaching for a card.

02 **Jules:** Certainly. Do you mean three [1] _____, or would you like separate checks according to what each person ordered? We can arrange either before payment.

03 **Morgan:** What would it come to if we divided it equally? We shared a couple of dishes, so that may be easiest.

04 **Jules:** The [2] _____ is seventy-two dollars. Divided equally among three people, that is twenty-four dollars each. Those three amounts add back to seventy-two.

05 **Morgan:** If someone wants to pay only for their own meal, can you do that too? We would need to sort out the shared starters.

06 **Jules:** Yes. That requires an [3] _____. We would also need your agreement about shared items rather than assume an equal division of those.

07 **Morgan:** We did share some food, so equal payments may be simpler for us. Let me confirm with the others before you enter anything.

08 **Jules:** Of course. The [4] _____ should be your group's choice. I will wait rather than treat our discussion as permission to process a payment.

09 **Morgan:** They have agreed. We want three equal payments, not separate bills based on individual dishes. Twenty-four each sounds right to us.

10 **Jules:** Thank you. I will arrange the [5] _____ as three payments of twenty-four dollars against the seventy-two-dollar total. Please confirm that is the method you want.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# What does three ways mean?

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Morgan:** Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars.

12 **Jules:** We will check each amount on the [6] _____ before it is confirmed. Agreeing twenty-four each does not mean a payment has already been taken.

13 **Morgan:** Does the seventy-two already include everything listed on this check? I just want to be sure we are dividing the final figure.

14 **Jules:** Correct. The [7] _____ amounts are included in the stated total. I will not invent an additional fee or assume a tip choice from this request.

15 **Morgan:** Could we each have a receipt for our own payment? Two of us need one for our records.

16 **Jules:** We can provide the relevant [8] _____ through our payment process. It needs to reflect the payment that is actually completed, not just the split we have agreed.

17 **Morgan:** We will pay one at a time, then. Could you show each person the amount before they tap?

18 **Jules:** Yes. The [9] _____ must reflect the actual payments recorded. Three agreed amounts are not a substitute for checking which transactions have completed.

19 **Morgan:** Yes, twenty-four each. We are all agreed now. You can bring the terminal when you are ready.

20 **Jules:** Exactly. We will obtain [10] _____ through the actual process. Three equal payments of twenty-four dollars is the instruction I am working from.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** equal shares / **2.** bill total / **3.** item allocation / **4.** allocation method / **5.** split payment / **6.** card terminal / **7.** listed charge / **8.** payment receipt / **9.** outstanding balance / **10.** payment confirmation

Why these answers fit, page 132

# F Check accuracy and scope

## What does three ways mean?

### Return to the case

Three diners have a fictional $72 bill, with all listed charges included. Guest Morgan asks to split it "three ways." The restaurant can arrange equal payments or separate checks by item before payment is processed. Server Jules must ask which method the diners mean. Equal shares would be $24 each; item-based shares cannot be calculated without the item allocation. No additional charge, tip decision, completed payment, or refund is supplied. Morgan later confirms that the group wants three equal payments, and Jules reads back that choice before processing.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. What is needed to calculate item-based checks?**

**A.** An agreed allocation of items and shared charges
**B.** Only the number of diners
**C.** A guessed tip amount
**D.** An assumption that all dishes cost the same

**2. What does confirmation of three equal payments establish?**

**A.** That every card has been charged
**B.** That a refund was issued
**C.** That all fees may be added again
**D.** The intended allocation, not completed payment

Answers and explanations, page 134

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Say three payments of twenty-four against seventy-two, then confirm that agreement is not completed payment.

### Do not make the social decision for the table

Guests may use split loosely, while differing about who should pay for shared dishes. Clarify the method without judging fairness or announcing private assumptions about relationships. Keep the conversation practical and confirm amounts before a payment is submitted.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Clarify four ways

Four diners have a $96 total with all listed charges included. The restaurant supports equal payments or item-based checks before payment. The diners confirm equal payments. No payment has been processed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

equal / ninety-six / processed / twenty-four

01 **Server:** You have chosen [1] _____ payments.

02 **Guest:** Each share is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Server:** The full total remains [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Guest:** The payments are not yet [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** equal / **2.** twenty-four / **3.** ninety-six / **4.** processed

Why these answers fit, page 134

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "Does the seventy-two already include everything listed on this check? I just want to be sure we are dividing the final figure." Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "Could we each have a receipt for our own payment? Two of us need one for our records." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Correct. The listed charge amounts are included in the stated total. I will not invent an additional fee or assume a tip choice from this request.

**B.** Thank you. I will arrange the split payment as three payments of twenty-four dollars against the seventy-two-dollar total. Please confirm that is the method you want.

**C.** Certainly. Do you mean three equal shares, or would you like separate checks according to what each person ordered? We can arrange either before payment.

**D.** We will check each amount on the card terminal before it is confirmed. Agreeing twenty-four each does not mean a payment has already been taken.

Answers and explanations, page 135

# Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Correcting a dish without blame" and "Explaining and splitting a bill". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

**1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Proposed substitute or corrected item that the guest may accept. Which term fits?**

**A.** estimated wait
**B.** delivered dish
**C.** replacement offer
**D.** void

**2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Dish or charge used by more than one diner. Which term fits?**

**A.** shared item
**B.** partial payment
**C.** gratuity
**D.** check

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "Can you move our order ahead of everyone else? I realize the kitchen is busy, but we cannot miss the event we are going to." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "Would it be quicker to change one of the dishes? I do not want to cancel the whole meal if a realistic option is available." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Correct. Pickup and delivery to the table are separate from the cooking estimate. I will clarify which stage the estimate covers when I speak with the kitchen.
**B.** The remaining time is from the seven-thirty update. That points to around seven thirty-eight for the stated estimate, but I cannot guarantee arrival at that exact time.
**C.** I can discuss a rush request with the kitchen. I cannot promise a different position or faster completion before they confirm what is actually possible.
**D.** Agreed. I will avoid a completion promise I cannot support. Your order status, the current estimate, and any decision we make next will stay clear.

# Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "We will pay one at a time, then. Could you show each person the amount before they tap?" Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "Yes, twenty-four each. We are all agreed now. You can bring the terminal when you are ready." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Yes. The outstanding balance must reflect the actual payments recorded. Three agreed amounts are not a substitute for checking which transactions have completed.

**B.** Exactly. We will obtain payment confirmation through the actual process. Three equal payments of twenty-four dollars is the instruction I am working from.

**C.** The bill total is seventy-two dollars. Divided equally among three people, that is twenty-four dollars each. Those three amounts add back to seventy-two.

**D.** Yes. That requires an item allocation. We would also need your agreement about shared items rather than assume an equal division of those.

Answers and explanations, page 150

# A Read the situation

**LESSON 07 / AGREEING ON CLEARING AND SHARED SERVICE**

Check permission to clear specific items and coordinate shared service without inferring that an empty plate is finished.

> **An empty plate still in use**
>
> At table 2, one diner has an empty plate, but the shared vegetable dish still contains food. The diner is using that plate for another portion. Server Mina and food runner Leo need to coordinate clearing. Extra sharing plates can be offered, but active items should remain unless the guest agrees otherwise. No request to end the meal or prepare the table for new guests has been made. The colleagues discuss the words Leo can use, then agree that he will ask what can be cleared rather than silently remove the plate.

People: Mina, Server responsible for table 2; Leo, Food runner helping with clearing.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. Why is the empty plate still needed?**

**A.** The table is being reset for new guests.
**B.** The plate is abandoned as an established fact.
**C.** The diner is using it for another portion.
**D.** The meal has definitely ended.

**2. What remains in the shared dish?**

**A.** Nothing at all
**B.** Vegetables
**C.** Only an empty serving vessel
**D.** A confirmed discarded meal

**3. What may the team offer?**

**A.** A bill adjustment already approved
**B.** Extra sharing plates
**C.** Unrequested removal of all active dishes
**D.** A new reservation without asking

Answers and explanations, page 136

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### clear
Remove dining items that are ready to be taken away.

*ask before clearing*

### busser
Team member who supports clearing, resetting, and related dining-room tasks.

*coordinate with the busser*

### sharing plate
Plate provided for taking a portion from a shared dish.

*offer a sharing plate*

### serving utensil
Tool used to transfer food from a serving dish to a plate.

*provide a serving utensil*

### side plate
Small plate used for bread, sides, or another specified purpose.

*offer a side plate*

### service station
Area holding supplies and equipment for dining-room work.

*organize the service station*

### pre-bus
Remove agreed finished items during a meal before the table's final clearing.

*pre-bus discreetly*

### food runner
Colleague who carries prepared dishes to guests and may assist service.

*brief the food runner*

### shared dish
Food presented for more than one person to serve from.

*leave the shared dish*

### place setting
Arrangement of dining items for one person.

*maintain the place setting*

### sideboard
Service furniture or station used to hold dining-room supplies.

*restock the sideboard*

### cutlery
Knives, forks, and spoons used for eating.

*replace the cutlery*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**clear** CLEAR

ask before clearing

Keep the meaning precise: Remove dining items that are ready to be taken away.

**shared dish** SHARED DISH

leave the shared dish

Keep the meaning precise: Food presented for more than one person to serve from.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### flatware
Common US term for eating utensils such as knives, forks, and spoons.
*provide clean flatware*

### crockery
Plates, bowls, and other ceramic dining vessels.
*handle the crockery*

### glassware
Drinking vessels made of glass.
*collect finished glassware*

### active item
Item still being used or needed by a guest.
*leave active items*

### finished item
Item the guest has finished using and agrees can be removed.
*identify finished items*

### clearing permission
Guest agreement to remove a particular item.
*obtain clearing permission*

### service cue
Action or signal that may suggest a service need but can require clarification.
*clarify a service cue*

### meal pace
Speed and rhythm at which guests are eating.
*respect the meal pace*

### table reset
Preparation of a cleared table for its next guests.
*begin an authorized table reset*

### table turnover
Transition from one party's use of a table to the next.
*manage table turnover*

### unobtrusive service
Assistance that meets guest needs without unnecessary interruption.
*provide unobtrusive service*

### guest preference
Individual request about how service should be provided.
*confirm the guest preference*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**cutlery** CUTLERY

replace the cutlery

Keep the meaning precise: Knives, forks, and spoons used for eating.

**finished item** FINISHED ITEM

identify finished items

Keep the meaning precise: Item the guest has finished using and agrees can be removed.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Ask about an item**
May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

**Check the shared dish**
Would you like the vegetables to stay on the table?

**Avoid an assumption**
An empty plate does not necessarily mean the guest has finished.

**State the observed fact**
The shared dish still has food in it.

**Wait for permission**
Let the guest answer before reaching for the plate.

**Avoid cultural guesses**
We should ask this table what they prefer.

**Preserve the shared arrangement**
Leave the serving dish and active plates in place.

**Pass on the preference**
The diner is keeping the plate for another portion.

**Accept continued use**
Of course; I will leave it for your next portion.

**Offer practical help**
Would extra sharing plates be useful?

**Coordinate the team**
Please leave that plate; it is still in use.

**Keep the question narrow**
Ask about the specific item rather than the whole meal.

**Respect a refusal**
Certainly; I will leave it where it is.

**Separate stages**
Clearing one finished item is not a table reset.

**Keep extra items optional**
We can offer more plates without adding them automatically.

**Close the service loop**
Confirm what may be cleared and tell the colleague helping you.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Offer practical help
**Useful wording:** Would extra sharing plates be useful?

**Purpose:** Avoid an assumption
**Useful wording:** An empty plate does not necessarily mean the guest has finished.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which question is most appropriate?**

**A.** Shall I clear everyone's plates now?
**B.** Would you like the bill now the plates are empty?
**C.** May I remove the shared vegetables with this plate?
**D.** May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

**2. What does the empty plate establish?**

**A.** A request for the bill
**B.** Its current contents, not that it is no longer needed
**C.** Permission to remove every dish
**D.** The diner's nationality

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Colleague who carries prepared dishes to guests and may assist service. Which term fits?**

**A.** side plate
**B.** food runner
**C.** glassware
**D.** table reset

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "An empty plate still in use". Leo: "What would you say without interrupting the conversation too much? I want the question to be clear but not sound as though I am trying to hurry them." Mina: [missing response] Leo: "If they say they are using it for more vegetables, I can simply say of course and leave it. I do not need them to justify it." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Correct. A table reset is another stage. Our immediate task is to support this table's meal, not turn an empty plate into a deadline.

**B.** Ask for clearing permission briefly: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then pause long enough for an answer.

**C.** Exactly. Unobtrusive service means noticing, asking briefly, and following the answer. Clear what is agreed, leave what is active, and keep the team informed.

**D.** Good. The shared dish and the individual plate belong to the same ongoing meal. Do not treat them as unrelated clearing decisions.

Answers and explanations, page 136

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Empty describes the plate contents at one moment. Finished describes the guest no longer needing it. The two are not equivalent here. A shared dish with food and an empty individual plate can belong to the same continuing meal.

# E Conversation

## An empty plate still in use

An empty plate still in use

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

shared dish / finished item / guest preference / sharing plate / Unobtrusive service / clearing permission / meal pace / table reset / active item / service cue

01 **Leo:** Mina, one plate at table two is empty. I was about to take it away, but the vegetable dish in the middle still has food.

02 **Mina:** Please leave that [1] _____ for now. The diner is using the plate for another portion, so empty does not mean finished in this situation.

03 **Leo:** I see. They are sharing, so the empty plate is not finished with. I will leave it where it is.

04 **Mina:** A [2] _____ can help us notice a need, but it is not always permission. We should check the actual item before reaching across the table.

05 **Leo:** What would you say without interrupting the conversation too much? I want the question to be clear but not sound as though I am trying to hurry them.

06 **Mina:** Ask for [3] _____ briefly: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then pause long enough for an answer.

07 **Leo:** If they say they are using it for more vegetables, I can simply say of course and leave it. I do not need them to justify it.

08 **Mina:** Exactly. Respect the [4] _____. We should not turn a small service question into a discussion of their dining customs or why they want to keep the plate.

09 **Leo:** We can offer extra plates as well, correct? That might make sharing easier, but I should not bring a stack of them without asking.

10 **Mina:** Yes, offer a [5] _____ or more if useful. Say, Would extra sharing plates help? We have that option available, but it should remain their choice.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# An empty plate still in use

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Leo:** I will keep the vegetables in place too. There is still food there, and no one has asked us to remove the dish.

12 **Mina:** Good. The [6] _____ and the individual plate belong to the same ongoing meal. Do not treat them as unrelated clearing decisions.

13 **Leo:** If another guest has actually finished with a glass or plate, may I check that item separately? I do not want to leave everything unnecessarily.

14 **Mina:** Yes. A [7] _____ can be handled separately. Ask specifically, and keep the action narrow enough that we do not accidentally clear something another diner is using.

15 **Leo:** Right. I will check the glass separately, not start taking the whole setting away while they still have food.

16 **Mina:** Correct. A [8] _____ is another stage. Our immediate task is to support this table's meal, not turn an empty plate into a deadline.

17 **Leo:** I will ask the diner, leave the active items, and offer extra sharing plates. Then I will tell you what they want so we stay consistent.

18 **Mina:** Thank you. That supports their [9] _____. It also prevents a second colleague from returning a moment later and asking to take the same plate.

19 **Leo:** I will keep it brief at the table. May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then I wait for the answer.

20 **Mina:** Exactly. [10] _____ means noticing, asking briefly, and following the answer. Clear what is agreed, leave what is active, and keep the team informed.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** active item / **2.** service cue / **3.** clearing permission / **4.** guest preference / **5.** sharing plate / **6.** shared dish / **7.** finished item / **8.** table reset / **9.** meal pace / **10.** Unobtrusive service

Why these answers fit, page 137

# F Check accuracy and scope

## An empty plate still in use

> **Return to the case**
>
> At table 2, one diner has an empty plate, but the shared vegetable dish still contains food. The diner is using that plate for another portion. Server Mina and food runner Leo need to coordinate clearing. Extra sharing plates can be offered, but active items should remain unless the guest agrees otherwise. No request to end the meal or prepare the table for new guests has been made. The colleagues discuss the words Leo can use, then agree that he will ask what can be cleared rather than silently remove the plate.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. Which instruction should Mina give Leo?**

**A.** Treat the meal as complete.
**B.** Add an unrequested charge for extra plates.
**C.** Leave the active plate and ask what may be cleared.
**D.** Remove the vegetables because one plate is empty.

**2. How should cultural differences be handled?**

**A.** Infer the answer from nationality.
**B.** Use one cutlery position as universal proof.
**C.** Require guests to explain their cultural background.
**D.** Ask the individual table about its preference.

Answers and explanations, page 139

> **Listen for the distinction**
>
> Switch roles. Pause after the permission question; distinguish an empty plate from a plate no longer needed.

> **Ask rather than apply a dining stereotype**
>
> Dining customs differ, but nationality is not a reliable instruction for a particular table. An empty plate, a pause, or a cutlery position can be ambiguous. Ask a short question about the actual item and respect the answer without making guests explain their culture.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Check a shared dessert plate

At table 9, an empty plate is still needed for more shared dessert. The dessert dish contains food. Extra small plates can be offered. No permission to clear the active plate has been given.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

given / offered / needed / dessert

01 **Server:** The empty plate is still [1] _____.

02 **Colleague:** The shared dish contains [2] _____.

03 **Server:** Extra small plates can be [3] _____.

04 **Colleague:** Clearing permission has not been [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** needed / **2.** dessert / **3.** offered / **4.** given

Why these answers fit, page 139

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "An empty plate still in use". Leo: "If another guest has actually finished with a glass or plate, may I check that item separately? I do not want to leave everything unnecessarily." Mina: [missing response] Leo: "Right. I will check the glass separately, not start taking the whole setting away while they still have food." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** A service cue can help us notice a need, but it is not always permission. We should check the actual item before reaching across the table.

**B.** Yes, offer a sharing plate or more if useful. Say, Would extra sharing plates help? We have that option available, but it should remain their choice.

**C.** Yes. A finished item can be handled separately. Ask specifically, and keep the action narrow enough that we do not accidentally clear something another diner is using.

**D.** Exactly. Respect the guest preference. We should not turn a small service question into a discussion of their dining customs or why they want to keep the plate.

Answers and explanations, page 140

# A Read the situation

**LESSON 08 / HANDING OVER A LIVE SECTION**

Give a concise table-by-table handover that separates meal stage, payment status, and an unresolved charge query.

> **Two tables, two unfinished tasks**
>
> At 8:00, outgoing server Ben hands tables 4 and 5 to Maya. Table 4 has received its mains, but dessert has not been ordered. Table 5 has an open check and a pending query about a possible duplicate coffee charge. The shift lead is reviewing that query; no duplicate has yet been confirmed and no adjustment is approved. Ben needs Maya to accept both follow-ups explicitly. The handover does not establish a dessert order, a settled bill, or a resolved coffee issue. Maya agrees to take responsibility for the next guest-facing steps.

People: Ben, Outgoing server; Maya, Incoming server.

## Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

**1. What is table 4's meal stage?**

**A.** Mains not yet ordered
**B.** Meal canceled
**C.** Mains served; dessert not ordered
**D.** Dessert served and paid

**2. What is table 5's check status?**

**A.** Never created
**B.** Open
**C.** Paid and closed
**D.** Refunded in full

**3. Who is reviewing the possible duplicate coffee charge?**

**A.** The guest as sole approver of every system change
**B.** No one
**C.** The shift lead
**D.** Maya as an already completed decision

Answers and explanations, page 141

# B Vocabulary in use

**CORE TERMS**

### section
Group of tables assigned to a server or service team.

*take over a section*

### live table
Table still receiving service or awaiting completion of a task.

*identify live tables*

### outgoing server
Colleague transferring responsibility at a shift or section change.

*brief the outgoing server*

### incoming server
Colleague accepting responsibility for the next service period.

*confirm the incoming server*

### handover
Transfer of relevant information and responsibility between colleagues.

*complete the section handover*

### handover time
Time at which the responsibility transfer is recorded or agreed.

*state the handover time*

### table status
Current service stage and relevant conditions for a table.

*summarize the table status*

### mains served
Status indicating main dishes have reached the guests.

*confirm mains served*

### dessert decision
Guest choice about whether and what dessert to order.

*follow up the dessert decision*

### open check
Bill that has not been settled and closed in the relevant system.

*monitor the open check*

### pending query
Question awaiting an answer or decision.

*carry forward a pending query*

### suspected duplicate
Possible repeated charge that still requires verification.

*review a suspected duplicate*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**section** SECTION

take over a section

Keep the meaning precise: Group of tables assigned to a server or service team.

**handover time** HANDOVER TIME

state the handover time

Keep the meaning precise: Time at which the responsibility transfer is recorded or agreed.

# B Precision and professional shorthand

**EXTEND YOUR RANGE**

### charge review

Examination of whether a billed amount is correct.

*request a charge review*

### service owner

Person responsible for the guest-facing follow-up.

*name the service owner*

### read-back confirmation

Repetition demonstrating that the receiving colleague understood the important details.

*obtain read-back confirmation*

### status change

Actual transition from one confirmed state to another.

*communicate a status change*

### unresolved item

Task or question that has not been completed or answered.

*track the unresolved item*

### decision owner

Person authorized or responsible for resolving a specified question.

*identify the decision owner*

### accepted follow-up

Next action explicitly taken on by the receiving colleague.

*record an accepted follow-up*

### closed check

Bill marked settled and closed through the actual payment process.

*verify a closed check*

### exception note

Record highlighting an issue outside routine service flow.

*preserve an exception note*

### continuity of service

Uninterrupted attention to guest needs across staff changes.

*maintain continuity of service*

# B Precision and professional shorthand / continued

### handover gap

Missing information or ownership during a transfer of responsibility.

*prevent a handover gap*

### follow-through

Completion of an accepted action and appropriate communication of its result.

*ensure follow-through*

## Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

**suspected duplicate** SUSPECTED DUPLICATE

review a suspected duplicate

Keep the meaning precise: Possible repeated charge that still requires verification.

**read-back confirmation** READ-BACK CONFIRMATION

obtain read-back confirmation

Keep the meaning precise: Repetition demonstrating that the receiving colleague understood the important details.

# C Phrases that move the work forward

**Open the transfer**
It is 8:00, and I am handing over tables 4 and 5.

**Keep dessert accurate**
Dessert has not been ordered.

**State table 5's balance status**
Table 5 has an open check.

**Preserve uncertainty**
The duplication has not been confirmed.

**Avoid false compensation**
No adjustment has been approved yet.

**Read back table 4**
I will follow up dessert without treating it as already ordered.

**Keep payment separate**
The check remains open until the actual payment process is completed.

**Avoid a false closure**
The issue is not resolved just because the section changes hands.

**State table 4's stage**
Table 4 has its mains.

**Name the first follow-up**
Please check whether table 4 wants dessert.

**Identify the query**
They have asked about a possible duplicate coffee charge.

**Name the decision owner**
The shift lead is reviewing the charge query.

**Ask for acceptance**
Can you take both follow-ups?

**Read back table 5**
I will track the coffee review and update the guests.

**Preserve the record**
Keep the unresolved query visible in the handover notes.

**Close with ownership**
Maya has accepted both guest-facing follow-ups; the shift lead retains the charge review.

## Precision in real exchanges

**Purpose:** Name the first follow-up
**Useful wording:** Please check whether table 4 wants dessert.

**Purpose:** State table 5's balance status
**Useful wording:** Table 5 has an open check.

# D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

**1. Which handover for table 4 is correct?**

**A.** Mains still need ordering

**B.** The table has left and paid

**C.** Mains served; dessert not ordered; follow up the dessert choice.

**D.** Dessert already entered for everyone

**2. Which coffee description is justified?**

**A.** A completed refund

**B.** An error already removed from every record

**C.** A possible duplicate charge under shift-lead review

**D.** A confirmed fraudulent charge

**3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Colleague accepting responsibility for the next service period. Which term fits?**

**A.** dessert decision

**B.** unresolved item

**C.** incoming server

**D.** service owner

# D Choose the response that fits / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two tables, two unfinished tasks". Ben: "Exactly. Ask about dessert when they are ready. There is nothing on the dessert ticket to chase." Maya: [missing response] Ben: "Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Agreed. Any status change will reflect what actually occurs. Accepted follow-up is not the same as completed service, approved adjustment, or settled payment.

**B.** I will handle the dessert decision with table four. That is the first task I am accepting. What is happening at table five?

**C.** I will preserve the wording suspected duplicate. I will not tell them the charge is definitely wrong simply because a query has been raised.

**D.** So the open check has a live query attached. I should not treat the bill as settled or the coffee line as already corrected.

Answers and explanations, page 141

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Mains served does not imply dessert ordered. Open check does not imply the bill is correct or the disputed item is wrong. A possible duplicate charge must remain a query until the review establishes the result.

# E Conversation

## Two tables, two unfinished tasks

Two tables, two unfinished tasks

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

continuity of service / exception note / suspected duplicate / status change / handover / dessert decision / mains served / read-back confirmation / service owner / open check

01 **Ben:** Maya, it is eight o'clock. I need to hand over tables four and five before I leave the section. Each has a different follow-up still open.

02 **Maya:** I am ready for the [1] _____. Please give me the current stage and unfinished request for each table so I can take them on clearly.

03 **Ben:** Table four has received its mains. Dessert has not been ordered, so please check their choice when it is appropriate in the service.

04 **Maya:** Understood: [2] _____, dessert not ordered. I will not enter desserts on the assumption that your mention of them means the guests have already chosen.

05 **Ben:** Exactly. Ask about dessert when they are ready. There is nothing on the dessert ticket to chase.

06 **Maya:** I will handle the [3] _____ with table four. That is the first task I am accepting. What is happening at table five?

07 **Ben:** Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question.

08 **Maya:** So the [4] _____ has a live query attached. I should not treat the bill as settled or the coffee line as already corrected.

09 **Ben:** Exactly. I have not been given a review result, and no bill adjustment has been approved. The guest needs an accurate update once there is a decision.

10 **Maya:** I will preserve the wording [5] _____. I will not tell them the charge is definitely wrong simply because a query has been raised.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Two tables, two unfinished tasks

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Ben:** The lead has the bill question. Can you check for the answer and keep table five updated after I leave?

12 **Maya:** I can be the [6] _____ for that follow-up. The shift lead makes the relevant decision; I track it and explain the actual outcome to the guests.

13 **Ben:** That is the distinction. Please keep the unresolved question visible in the notes as well, so it does not disappear when the section assignment changes.

14 **Maya:** I will retain the [7] _____ and the current status. A change of server should not make a pending charge question look like routine payment completed.

15 **Ben:** Can you read back both tasks once more? I want to be sure I have not mixed the table numbers while we are moving between them.

16 **Maya:** My [8] _____ is table four: follow up the dessert choice. Table five: track the shift-lead coffee review and give the guests the actual update.

17 **Ben:** Correct. Five is still open, and we have no approved adjustment. Please keep that separate from the fact you have taken the table.

18 **Maya:** Agreed. Any [9] _____ will reflect what actually occurs. Accepted follow-up is not the same as completed service, approved adjustment, or settled payment.

19 **Ben:** Good. You have both follow-ups, and the shift lead still has the charge decision. That gives each next step a clear person to contact.

20 **Maya:** Yes, I accept both. I will maintain [10] _____ for the two tables, check the pending decision, and keep the records aligned with what the guests are actually told.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** handover / **2.** mains served / **3.** dessert decision / **4.** open check / **5.** suspected duplicate / **6.** service owner / **7.** exception note / **8.** read-back confirmation / **9.** status change / **10.** continuity of service

Why these answers fit, page 142

# F Check accuracy and scope

## Two tables, two unfinished tasks

### Return to the case

At 8:00, outgoing server Ben hands tables 4 and 5 to Maya. Table 4 has received its mains, but dessert has not been ordered. Table 5 has an open check and a pending query about a possible duplicate coffee charge. The shift lead is reviewing that query; no duplicate has yet been confirmed and no adjustment is approved. Ben needs Maya to accept both follow-ups explicitly. The handover does not establish a dessert order, a settled bill, or a resolved coffee issue. Maya agrees to take responsibility for the next guest-facing steps.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

**1. Which ownership arrangement is clear?**

**A.** Ben's departure automatically closes the query.
**B.** Maya announces approval before receiving a decision.
**C.** Maya accepts guest follow-up while the shift lead reviews the charge.
**D.** Everyone assumes someone else will handle it.

**2. What must precede calling table 5's check closed?**

**A.** The actual relevant payment and closure process
**B.** Merely changing servers
**C.** Writing possible duplicate in a note
**D.** Assuming dessert is unnecessary

Answers and explanations, page 144

### Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Repeat Maya's two accepted follow-ups, preserving the shift lead's separate charge-review responsibility.

### A handover is an accepted responsibility

A rushed list of table numbers can hide unfinished work. State the meal stage, the open request, and the person handling any decision. Ask the receiving colleague to repeat the important details so that moving between shifts does not make a live guest concern disappear.

# F Say it / transfer to a new case

## Hand over two different tables

At 9:00, Noor takes tables 8 and 9. Table 8 has mains served and no dessert order. Table 9 has an open check with a possible duplicate tea charge under lead review. Noor accepts both follow-ups.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

tea / open / dessert / Noor

01 **Outgoing server:** Table 8 needs a [1] _____ follow-up.

02 **Incoming server:** Table 9's check remains [2] _____.

03 **Outgoing server:** The queried item is [3] _____.

04 **Incoming server:** The receiving server is [4] _____.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** dessert / **2.** open / **3.** tea / **4.** Noor

Why these answers fit, page 144

### Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two tables, two unfinished tasks". Ben: "That is the distinction. Please keep the unresolved question visible in the notes as well, so it does not disappear when the section assignment changes." Maya: [missing response] Ben: "Can you read back both tasks once more? I want to be sure I have not mixed the table numbers while we are moving between them." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Understood: mains served, dessert not ordered. I will not enter desserts on the assumption that your mention of them means the guests have already chosen.

**B.** I will retain the exception note and the current status. A change of server should not make a pending charge question look like routine payment completed.

**C.** I can be the service owner for that follow-up. The shift lead makes the relevant decision; I track it and explain the actual outcome to the guests.

**D.** I am ready for the handover. Please give me the current stage and unfinished request for each table so I can take them on clearly.

Answers and explanations, page 145

# Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Agreeing on clearing and shared service" and "Handing over a live section". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

**1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Team member who supports clearing, resetting, and related dining-room tasks. Which term fits?**

**A.** meal pace

**B.** crockery

**C.** place setting

**D.** busser

**2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Status indicating main dishes have reached the guests. Which term fits?**

**A.** status change

**B.** charge review

**C.** section

**D.** mains served

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "They have agreed. We want three equal payments, not separate bills based on individual dishes. Twenty-four each sounds right to us." Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** Certainly. Do you mean three equal shares, or would you like separate checks according to what each person ordered? We can arrange either before payment.

**B.** Correct. The listed charge amounts are included in the stated total. I will not invent an additional fee or assume a tip choice from this request.

**C.** Thank you. I will arrange the split payment as three payments of twenty-four dollars against the seventy-two-dollar total. Please confirm that is the method you want.

**D.** We will check each amount on the card terminal before it is confirmed. Agreeing twenty-four each does not mean a payment has already been taken.

# Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two tables, two unfinished tasks". Ben: "Correct. Five is still open, and we have no approved adjustment. Please keep that separate from the fact you have taken the table." Maya: [missing response] Ben: "Good. You have both follow-ups, and the shift lead still has the charge decision. That gives each next step a clear person to contact." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A.** I will preserve the wording suspected duplicate. I will not tell them the charge is definitely wrong simply because a query has been raised.

**B.** I will handle the dessert decision with table four. That is the first task I am accepting. What is happening at table five?

**C.** Agreed. Any status change will reflect what actually occurs. Accepted follow-up is not the same as completed service, approved adjustment, or settled payment.

**D.** So the open check has a live query attached. I should not treat the bill as settled or the coffee line as already corrected.

Answers and explanations, page 152

# Language for the next case

## The last salmon is spoken for

### committed portions

Three of the four physical portions already belong to accepted tickets, leaving only one for a new order.

*Omar: Four is the physical count, including the three committed portions. We have one available for a new order, not four.*

### 86 list

The 86 list identifies items unavailable for further orders; it does not cancel portions already committed to accepted tickets.

*Omar: Agreed. Once we allocate that last one, salmon goes on the 86 list. The existing three tickets still get theirs.*

### substitution

The substitution replaces seat two's requested salmon with the pasta that the guest actually selected.

*Omar: I have allocated the last salmon to seat one. Record the substitution against seat two only, with the guest's confirmed choice.*

### price difference

Two salmon would total $52; one $26 salmon plus $21 pasta totals $47, a $5 difference for these mains.

*Omar: Yes, a five-dollar price difference for these mains. It is not a separate discount on top of the pasta's twenty-one-dollar price.*

### replacement choice

Seat two explicitly chose mushroom pasta after the shortage and price were explained; it is not a kitchen-selected substitute.

*Nina: Table eighteen: seat one salmon, twenty-six; seat two mushroom pasta, twenty-one. The pasta is the replacement choice the guest has agreed to.*

### availability update

The availability update must communicate that no further salmon orders can be accepted; existing committed orders remain distinct.

*Nina: I will confirm the availability update reached the floor and ordering channels. I will not remove salmon from the tickets already accepted.*

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

# Conversation

## The last salmon is spoken for

Fictional dinner service: four salmon portions remain, with three already committed to accepted tickets. Table 18 requests two more. The kitchen allocates the last available portion to one named guest after confirmation; the other chooses mushroom pasta at $21 instead of salmon at $26. There is no reported allergy.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

committed portions / price difference / substitution / replacement choice / availability update / 86 list

01 **Nina:** Table eighteen wants two salmon. The board says four left, but I can see three salmon on accepted tickets. Is that four before those orders or four still available?

02 **Omar:** Four is the physical count, including the three [1] _____. We have one available for a new order, not four.

03 **Nina:** Then I cannot promise both guests salmon. Please hold the table's new request while I explain the shortage and ask who would like the remaining portion.

04 **Omar:** Agreed. Once we allocate that last one, salmon goes on the [2] _____. The existing three tickets still get theirs.

05 **Nina:** For the guests, I will say we have one salmon portion left. I will not tell them we have eighty-six salmon or use the shorthand without explaining.

06 **Omar:** Good. Tell them what is available and let them choose. Mushroom pasta is available at twenty-one dollars; salmon is twenty-six.

# Conversation / continued

07 **Nina:** I have checked with table eighteen. Seat one wants the last salmon. Seat two has chosen the pasta after hearing both prices.

08 **Omar:** I have allocated the last salmon to seat one. Record the [3] _____ against seat two only, with the guest's confirmed choice.

09 **Nina:** That makes forty-seven dollars for those two mains, before any other bill items or applicable charges. It was fifty-two for two salmon.

10 **Omar:** Yes, a five-dollar [4] _____ for these mains. It is not a separate discount on top of the pasta's twenty-one-dollar price.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# The last salmon is spoken for

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Nina:** I will enter the pasta at its own price, not leave a salmon charge and hope someone remembers to change it later.

12 **Omar:** Please read the updated ticket back to me before we proceed. I need the table, seats, dishes, and the fact that only seat two changed.

13 **Nina:** Table eighteen: seat one salmon, twenty-six; seat two mushroom pasta, twenty-one. The pasta is the [5] _____ the guest has agreed to.

14 **Omar:** Confirmed. I have the last salmon allocated. We now have zero available for additional orders, although four portions still physically await preparation.

15 **Nina:** I will tell the section team and ask the authorized person to update the ordering system. Should we also check the online menu?

16 **Omar:** Yes, verify each relevant ordering channel. Do not assume a handwritten board or one screen changes every listing, especially where items have separate records.

17 **Nina:** I will confirm the [6] _____ reached the floor and ordering channels. I will not remove salmon from the tickets already accepted.

18 **Omar:** Exactly. If another guest asks, offer the current alternatives and their prices. Do not promise a portion that belongs to one of these tickets.

19 **Nina:** Then the final read-back is three earlier salmon, one salmon for table eighteen seat one, and pasta for seat two. No salmon remains to sell.

20 **Omar:** That matches. Send the corrected table order through our process, and keep the stock message separate from the guest's individual change.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** committed portions / **2.** 86 list / **3.** substitution / **4.** price difference / **5.** replacement choice / **6.** availability update

Why these answers fit, page 154

# Count what can still be sold

Six sea-bass portions physically remain; four are committed to accepted tickets. Three new guests request sea bass. Two choose the available portions at $28 each; the third agrees to $24 chicken. Other bill items and charges are outside this comparison.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

two / chicken / 80 / unavailable

01 **Server:** There are [1] _____ portions available before the new choices.

02 **Expeditor:** The third guest has agreed to [2] _____ .

03 **Server:** These three mains total [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Expeditor:** After allocation, sea bass is [4] _____ for further orders.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** two / **2.** chicken / **3.** 80 / **4.** unavailable

Why these answers fit, page 154

**Keep the distinction audible**

Reconcile remaining portions, communicate an unavailable item, and obtain an actual replacement choice.

# Language for the next case

## Service charge or optional tip?

### service charge

The $27 service charge is mandatory under this fictional restaurant's disclosed terms, unlike an additional voluntary tip.

*Alma: Of course. The service charge is the eighteen-percent charge shown in our terms. The extra tip on the terminal is optional.*

### subtotal

The stated $150 food-and-drinks subtotal is the basis for this charge; the example does not apply eighteen percent to the final total.

*Alma: The subtotal for food and drinks is one hundred fifty dollars. Eighteen percent of that is twenty-seven dollars.*

### amount due

The supplied amounts sum to $189 before a voluntary extra tip; the already listed tax and service charge must not be added again.

*Alma: Correct. One hundred fifty plus twenty-seven plus twelve gives the amount due of one hundred eighty-nine, before any extra tip you choose.*

### additional gratuity

An additional gratuity is a voluntary extra amount; selecting zero there does not remove the existing mandatory service charge.

*Alma: No. Zero on the optional-tip screen means no additional gratuity. The existing bill still totals one hundred eighty-nine.*

### distribution policy

The case supplies no policy explaining how the service charge is distributed; Alma must not invent a staff share.

*Alma: I would need our manager to explain the actual distribution policy. I should not promise where every dollar goes without checking.*

### listed tax

The case supplies a $12 tax line, not a universal rate or rule about which charges are taxable.

*Alma: No general tax rule follows from this check. The twelve dollars is the listed tax in our example. Applicable tax treatment and other restaurants' terms need their own verification.*

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

# Conversation

## Service charge or optional tip?

Fictional US check: food and drinks subtotal $150; disclosed mandatory service charge 18% of that subtotal, $27; separately listed tax $12. Total before any voluntary extra tip is $189. The terminal offers an optional tip. No staff-distribution policy or general tax-rate rule is supplied.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

subtotal / distribution policy / additional gratuity / amount due / listed tax / service charge

01 **Dev:** Could you explain these two lines? There is already a service charge on the bill, but the terminal is asking about a tip as well.

02 **Alma:** Of course. The [1] _____ is the eighteen-percent charge shown in our terms. The extra tip on the terminal is optional.

03 **Dev:** Eighteen percent of which amount? I want to check the arithmetic because the tax is listed on a separate line.

04 **Alma:** The [2] _____ for food and drinks is one hundred fifty dollars. Eighteen percent of that is twenty-seven dollars.

05 **Dev:** And the twelve dollars below it is tax already included in the total shown? It is not another amount I need to add myself?

06 **Alma:** Correct. One hundred fifty plus twenty-seven plus twelve gives the [3] _____ of one hundred eighty-nine, before any extra tip you choose.

07 **Dev:** I was worried the screen would add eighteen percent again. Does leaving the tip at zero remove the existing service charge?

08 **Alma:** No. Zero on the optional-tip screen means no [4] _____. The existing bill still totals one hundred eighty-nine.

09 **Dev:** I would like to pay that total without an extra tip today. I do not want to select a suggested percentage by mistake.

10 **Alma:** Certainly. Please use the no-extra-tip choice and check the amount displayed before confirming. I can explain the screen without selecting an amount for you.

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Service charge or optional tip?

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Dev:** Thank you. Does the service charge go directly to you, or is it shared among the team?

12 **Alma:** I would need our manager to explain the actual [5] _____. I should not promise where every dollar goes without checking.

13 **Dev:** Please do ask. I am not trying to argue with you; I just want to understand what I am paying and what the staff receive.

14 **Alma:** I understand. The bill calculation and the distribution question are separate. I can show the first now and get the manager's answer to the second.

15 **Dev:** Is this how every restaurant calculates tax on service charges? I have seen different layouts on other bills.

16 **Alma:** No general tax rule follows from this check. The twelve dollars is the [6] _____ in our example. Applicable tax treatment and other restaurants' terms need their own verification.

17 **Dev:** All right. The calculation here is clear: one hundred fifty for the order, twenty-seven service charge, twelve tax. I am choosing no extra tip.

18 **Alma:** Yes. Please check that the terminal shows one hundred eighty-nine for your selected payment. Agreeing the amount does not itself complete the transaction.

19 **Dev:** It shows the amount we discussed. I will confirm it myself, and I would like an itemized receipt afterward.

20 **Alma:** Certainly. I will provide the receipt through our payment process and follow up with the manager on your distribution question. I will not treat that question as already answered.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** service charge / **2.** subtotal / **3.** amount due / **4.** additional gratuity / **5.** distribution policy / **6.** listed tax

Why these answers fit, page 156

# Explain a different check

A fictional check lists an $80 subtotal, a mandatory 15% service charge on that subtotal, and $6 listed tax. The guest chooses no additional tip. No staff-distribution percentage or universal tax rule is supplied.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

98 / zero / 12 / unspecified

01 **Guest:** The service charge is [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Server:** The total before any extra tip is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Guest:** My additional tip choice is [3] _____ .

04 **Server:** The staff-distribution policy remains [4] _____ .

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** 12 / **2.** 98 / **3.** zero / **4.** unspecified

Why these answers fit, page 156

**Keep the distinction audible**

Explain an itemized charge and optional payment choice without making unsupported claims about tax or staff distribution.

# Language for the next case

## Read the menu, keep the choice

### format

Format describes how the menu information is presented; Theo asks what works instead of assuming the phone or print is accessible.

*Theo: Certainly. Would you like just that section first, or would another format work better for you?*

### Parmesan

Parmesan is the explicitly listed risotto ingredient; omitting it would withhold relevant menu information from Rosa.

*Theo: There are two listed options. The mushroom risotto is twenty-two dollars and includes Parmesan. The chickpea stew is twenty dollars and comes with bread.*

### chickpea stew

Chickpea stew is the second listed main, priced at $20 and served with bread.

*Theo: The chickpea stew is twenty dollars, including bread. The risotto is twenty-two.*

### choice

Rosa explicitly selects the stew with its bread; Theo confirms the guest's own decision rather than choosing for her.

*Theo: Stew with bread as listed. Is that the choice you would like me to enter?*

### read back

Read back means repeat the selected order aloud so Rosa can check it without depending on the printed menu.

*Theo: You are welcome. I will read back your order before sending it: chickpea stew with bread, twenty dollars; water for now.*

### itemized bill

An itemized bill separates the ordered items and listed charges; reading it lets Rosa review the bill herself.

*Theo: Certainly. We can review the itemized bill and total together using a method that works for you.*

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

# Conversation

## Read the menu, keep the choice

Guest Rosa has low vision and asks server Theo to read the two vegetarian mains with prices. The current menu lists mushroom risotto $22 with Parmesan, and chickpea stew $20 with bread. Rosa chooses the stew and asks to keep the bread. No vegan request or allergy is reported.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

read back / Parmesan / choice / format / chickpea stew / itemized bill

01 **Rosa:** Could you read the vegetarian mains to me, including the prices? I cannot read this print comfortably, and the menu on my phone is not opening.

02 **Theo:** Certainly. Would you like just that section first, or would another [1] _____ work better for you?

03 **Rosa:** Reading that section would be helpful. Please tell me what comes with each dish, not only the names.

04 **Theo:** There are two listed options. The mushroom risotto is twenty-two dollars and includes [2] _____. The chickpea stew is twenty dollars and comes with bread.

05 **Rosa:** Could you repeat the stew price? I heard the two dishes, but missed the second amount when someone passed behind me.

06 **Theo:** The [3] _____ is twenty dollars, including bread. The risotto is twenty-two.

07 **Rosa:** Thank you. I will have the stew. Please keep the bread; I do not need anything taken off.

08 **Theo:** Stew with bread as listed. Is that the [4] _____ you would like me to enter?

09 **Rosa:** Yes. My friend may order something different, so please keep our choices separate.

10 **Theo:** Of course. I will take each order directly. Would you like me to read the drinks section too?

Conversation continues on the next page.

# Read the menu, keep the choice

**CONVERSATION / CONTINUED**

11 **Rosa:** Not yet. I will stay with water for now. Thank you for asking rather than working through the whole menu while I am deciding.

12 **Theo:** You are welcome. I will [5] _____ your order before sending it: chickpea stew with bread, twenty dollars; water for now.

13 **Rosa:** That is correct. Is the twenty dollars the price of the stew, or have you included anything else in that figure?

14 **Theo:** It is the menu price for the stew with bread. I have not represented it as the final bill total with every possible charge included.

15 **Rosa:** Good. When the check comes, could you read the items and total to me as well? I want to check it myself.

16 **Theo:** Certainly. We can review the [6] _____ and total together using a method that works for you.

17 **Rosa:** One more thing: my companion does not need to answer for me. I may ask for help reading, but I can make my own order.

18 **Theo:** Understood. I will speak directly with you and ask what assistance is useful. I will not treat help with print as permission to make your choices.

19 **Rosa:** Thank you. Then I am ready to order the stew with bread. Please let me know if anything in that description has changed.

20 **Theo:** I will check any changed detail rather than silently substitute. Your selected order is clear, and I will follow our normal ordering process.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** format / **2.** Parmesan / **3.** chickpea stew / **4.** choice / **5.** read back / **6.** itemized bill

Why these answers fit, page 158

# Read the requested section accurately

Guest Jo asks for the two desserts and prices to be read aloud. The menu lists apple crumble $8 with vanilla ice cream, and mango sorbet $7. Jo chooses the sorbet. No allergy or dietary restriction is reported.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

**WORD AND PHRASE BANK**

ice cream / 7 / 8 / sorbet

01 **Server:** The crumble costs [1] _____ dollars.

02 **Guest:** The crumble comes with vanilla [2] _____ .

03 **Server:** Your chosen dessert is mango [3] _____ .

04 **Guest:** Its menu price is [4] _____ dollars.

**CHECK THE GAPS**

**1.** 8 / **2.** ice cream / **3.** sorbet / **4.** 7

Why these answers fit, page 158

**Keep the distinction audible**

Offer useful menu access, communicate prices and ingredients precisely, and address the guest directly.

# 01 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. Which seat has not chosen?

**C. Seat three**

The brief explicitly leaves seat three's dish undecided.

Return to the exercise, page 4

### A2. Which request already belongs to the salad?

**B. Dressing separately**

Seat two requested salad with the dressing served separately.

Return to the exercise, page 4

### A3. What did Lena need to clarify when she first heard the request?

**D. Which dish should have no onions**

The onion request initially lacked a dish reference; Sam subsequently attached it to the salad.

Return to the exercise, page 4

## D / Response choices

### D1. Which clarification is most useful?

**A. Which dish should have no onions?**

The question asks for the missing dish reference without blame or unsupported changes.

Return to the exercise, page 8

### D2. What should be sent as the salad modifier after Sam confirms?

**D. No onions, dressing on the side**

Sam confirms the onion request for the salad, which already has separate dressing.

Return to the exercise, page 8

# 01 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Written surface used to record guest orders. Which term fits?

**D. order pad**

**A Not here.** starter: Dish served before the main course in the relevant menu format. The usual combination is "order a starter".

**B Not here.** pending choice: Selection that has not yet been made. The usual combination is "keep a choice pending".

**C Not here.** substitution: Replacement of one component with another when available and permitted. The usual combination is "check a substitution".

**D Correct.** order pad: Written surface used to record guest orders. The usual combination is "update the order pad".

Return to the exercise, page 8

### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Who asked for no onions?". Lena: "Mushroom pasta, unchanged. Seat three was still looking at the menu when I came over, so I have left that choice open." Cam: [missing response] Lena: "I will go back to that guest. Before I do, can you repeat what you have? I want to catch any mismatch now." Which response belongs in the gap?

**A. Keep it as a pending choice, then. Do not copy the pasta into the third seat just to fill the space.**

**A Correct.** This is Cam's response in turn 6. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. Seat three has not selected a dish; a pending choice is neither a cancellation nor an order.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Lena says: "I have not sent anything yet. I wanted to settle the unclear detail first rather than ask the kitchen to interpret my note." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Lena says: "Correct. The salad has both requests. I originally wrote them between the items because two people were speaking at once." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Lena says: "I will go back to that guest. Before I do, can you repeat what you have? I want to catch any mismatch now." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 8

## E / Conversation

### 1. modifier

**Turn 2.** The modifier changes the salad order; Lena has confirmed that the onion request belongs to Sam at seat two.

# 01 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. on the side

**Turn 4.** On the side means the dressing is served separately, as Sam requested for the salad.

### 3. pending choice

**Turn 6.** Seat three has not selected a dish; a pending choice is neither a cancellation nor an order.

### 4. read-back

**Turn 8.** A read-back repeats the recorded details so the colleagues can catch an error before transmission.

### 5. seat reference

**Turn 10.** The seat reference attaches both salad requests to seat two and leaves seat one's pasta unchanged.

### 6. order ticket

**Turn 12.** The order ticket communicates preparation instructions; its modifiers must stay with the correct dish when sent.

### 7. covers

**Turn 14.** Covers counts diners; three diners does not establish three completed main-course orders.

### 8. omission

**Turn 16.** The omission is removal of onions from the salad; no allergy has been reported in this case.

### 9. confirmation

**Turn 18.** Confirmation checks the actual chosen dish and details; the unfinished third choice cannot be confirmed in advance.

### 10. send the order

**Turn 20.** Send the order means transmit the checked details, after resolving the remaining choice through the restaurant's process.

Return to the conversation, page 10

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. Which statement preserves the pending choice?

**D. Seat three is still deciding.**

The brief leaves the third choice open rather than establishing a dish or cancellation.

Return to the exercise, page 12

# 01 / Answers and explanations / continued

### F2. What does the onion request establish medically?

**A. No allergy diagnosis or report by itself**

A requested omission alone does not supply an allergy report or a safety conclusion.

Return to the exercise, page 12

## F / Guided speaking

### 1. fish

**Server:** The lemon request belongs to the fish.

**Turn 1.** The clarification specifically attaches the separate lemon to the grilled fish.

### 2. two

**Guest:** That is seat two.

**Turn 2.** The guest ordering grilled fish is in seat two.

### 3. unchanged

**Server:** The tomato soup remains unchanged.

**Turn 3.** No modification to the soup is supplied in the facts.

### 4. covers

**Guest:** There are two covers.

**Turn 4.** Covers counts diners, and this table has two diners.

Return to the conversation, page 13

# 01 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Who asked for no onions?". Lena: "The screen shows three diners, but only two main dishes so far. That is why the totals do not match yet." Cam: [missing response] Lena: "Sam said no onions, but did not report an allergy. I repeated the request and confirmed the dish rather than guessing the reason." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A. Three covers, two confirmed mains. That is fine while the last person is choosing. The diner count does not supply a missing order.**

**A Correct.** This is Cam's response in turn 14. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. Covers counts diners; three diners does not establish three completed main-course orders.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Lena says: "I have not sent anything yet. I wanted to settle the unclear detail first rather than ask the kitchen to interpret my note." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Lena says: "I will go back to that guest. Before I do, can you repeat what you have? I want to catch any mismatch now." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Lena says: "Cam, can you check table twelve with me before I send it? Three guests, two mains chosen. I clarified the onion request with Sam at seat two." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 13

# 02 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. What is the steak set price?

**D. $29**

The $24 base plus the $5 steak supplement equals $29.

Return to the exercise, page 14

### A2. Which item is included in both steak options?

**B. Potatoes**

Both the steak set and a la carte steak include potatoes.

Return to the exercise, page 14

### A3. What is not supplied?

**D. A separate dessert price**

The case gives the set comparison, not a standalone dessert price.

Return to the exercise, page 14

## D / Response choices

### D1. Which calculation is correct?

**B. $24 + $5 = $29 for the steak set**

The supplement is added to the set base, not to the a la carte price.

Return to the exercise, page 18

### D2. Which comparison is complete?

**D. $29 with dessert versus $27 without dessert; both include potatoes.**

This comparison gives the actual prices and distinguishes shared and different inclusions.

Return to the exercise, page 18

# 02 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Starting price before specified additions. Which term fits?

**B. base price**

**A Not here.** daily special: Dish or offer identified as special for the relevant service period. The usual combination is "explain the daily special".

**B Correct.** base price: Starting price before specified additions. The usual combination is "state the base price".

**C Not here.** optional extra: Additional item that is not compulsory or automatically included. The usual combination is "describe an optional extra".

**D Not here.** standalone price: Price charged for an item bought separately. The usual combination is "verify the standalone price".

Return to the exercise, page 18

### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "I also see steak listed separately at twenty-seven. Is that another way of ordering the same main without taking the lunch set?" Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Good, I was about to ask about the potatoes. I do not want to discover I need to order a side as well." Which response belongs in the gap?

**B. Yes, that is the a la carte option. The steak is twenty-seven without dessert. Both options include potatoes, so you do not need to add them to this comparison.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 14, after Jordan says: "That makes sense. I may not want dessert after the steak. Could you give me a moment to choose?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Priya's response in turn 6. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. A la carte identifies an individual menu item rather than the main-and-dessert set being compared.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 20, after Jordan says: "Let me check with my friend about dessert before I decide. I have not chosen the set yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Jordan says: "Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

## E / Conversation

### 1. base price

**Turn 2.** The base price is the set's starting amount before the listed five-dollar steak supplement is added.

# 02 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. supplement

**Turn 4.** A supplement is an addition to the stated base, not a replacement price or the cost of the whole dish.

### 3. a la carte

**Turn 6.** A la carte identifies an individual menu item rather than the main-and-dessert set being compared.

### 4. inclusion

**Turn 8.** An inclusion is covered by the quoted option; potatoes are included in both steak choices in this menu.

### 5. price difference

**Turn 10.** The price difference is twenty-nine minus twenty-seven, or two dollars between these two specific options.

### 6. standalone price

**Turn 12.** The standalone price applies to a dessert bought separately; the two-dollar bundle difference does not establish it.

### 7. value comparison

**Turn 14.** A value comparison considers both price and inclusions, allowing the guest to decide whether the dessert matters.

### 8. main-and-dessert set

**Turn 16.** The main-and-dessert set names the included courses; coffee is not supplied as an inclusion in this comparison.

### 9. price basis

**Turn 18.** The price basis specifies what each quoted amount covers, avoiding unsupported claims about other items or charges.

### 10. guest choice

**Turn 20.** The guest choice must be confirmed explicitly; discussing an option at length does not authorize ordering it.

Return to the conversation, page 20

# 02 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. What cannot be inferred from the two-dollar difference?

**B. The restaurant's standalone dessert price is $2.**

A difference between bundled offers does not establish the separate selling price of a component.

Return to the exercise, page 22

### F2. Which recommendation avoids pressure?

**B. If you want dessert, the set includes it for two dollars more than steak alone.**

The recommendation uses the supplied price and inclusion difference without inventing benefits or removing choice.

Return to the exercise, page 22

## F / Guided speaking

### 1. twenty-four

**Server:** The fish set costs twenty-four dollars.

**Turn 1.** Twenty dollars plus the four-dollar supplement equals twenty-four dollars.

### 2. twenty-two

**Guest:** Fish alone is twenty-two dollars.

**Turn 2.** The stated a la carte price is twenty-two dollars without dessert.

### 3. rice

**Server:** Both options include rice.

**Turn 3.** Rice is included in both options under the supplied menu.

### 4. unspecified

**Guest:** The separate dessert price is unspecified.

**Turn 4.** The bundle comparison does not supply a standalone dessert price.

Return to the conversation, page 23

# 02 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "That makes sense. I may not want dessert after the steak. Could you give me a moment to choose?" Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Is coffee included with the dessert in that set? I sometimes see that elsewhere, but I cannot find it in this description." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**B. Of course. A useful value comparison depends on what you want to eat. The more expensive option is not automatically the better choice for you.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Jordan says: "Could you help me with the lunch menu? I saw twenty-four dollars beside the set, but there is another amount beside the steak." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Priya's response in turn 14. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. A value comparison considers both price and inclusions, allowing the guest to decide whether the dessert matters.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Jordan says: "Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Jordan says: "Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 23

# 03 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. Which allergen does Eli report?

**D. Sesame**

Eli explicitly reports a sesame allergy in the brief.

Return to the exercise, page 26

### A2. What information does Noor hold?

**A. An old menu description**

The available description is old and does not establish current ingredients or handling.

Return to the exercise, page 26

### A3. Who is available before an order is sent?

**D. Kitchen lead Cam**

Cam is identified as available to discuss the allergy question.

Return to the exercise, page 26

## D / Response choices

### D1. Which first response is best?

**B. Thank you for telling me; I will check the current bun and handling information with Cam.**

The response acknowledges the allergy and directs the unresolved questions to current product and preparation checks.

Return to the exercise, page 30

### D2. Which distinction matters?

**B. Ingredients and cross-contact are separate questions.**

A product's intended ingredients do not alone answer how unintended allergen contact is managed.

Return to the exercise, page 30

# 03 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Record of substances intentionally used in a product. Which term fits?

**D. ingredient list**

**A Not here.** shared equipment: Equipment used for more than one food or preparation. The usual combination is "check shared equipment".

**B Not here.** reported allergen: Substance the guest identifies as the source of an allergy. The usual combination is "repeat the reported allergen".

**C Not here.** allergy flag: Clear system marker identifying a reported allergy for the relevant order. The usual combination is "enter an allergy flag".

**D Correct.** ingredient list: Record of substances intentionally used in a product. The usual combination is "check the current ingredient list".

Return to the exercise, page 30

### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Checking the bun before ordering". Eli: "Please include how it is handled, not just the ingredients. I would rather wait for an accurate answer than have someone tell me it is probably fine." Noor: [missing response] Eli: "Have you been able to pass that question to Cam? I would like to know it has reached the person checking the kitchen information." Which response belongs in the gap?

**B. Of course. I will ask about the ingredients and cross-contact. I cannot confirm suitability from this description, and I will not put the order through while that question is unresolved.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Eli says: "Before I order, I need to ask about the burger bun. I have a sesame allergy, and the picture does not tell me what is in the bread." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Noor's response in turn 6. It connects Eli's preceding point with Eli's follow-up. Cross-contact concerns unintended allergen introduction, which is not answered solely by the bun's intended ingredient list.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 16, after Eli says: "Has the kitchen actually checked the bun yet, or are they still finding the information?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Eli says: "Have you been able to pass that question to Cam? I would like to know it has reached the person checking the kitchen information." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 30

## E / Conversation

### 1. reported allergen

**Turn 2.** The reported allergen is sesame, which must be communicated accurately rather than replaced by a vague dietary note.

# 03 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. current product

**Turn 4.** The current product is the bun actually used today; an old description cannot establish its present ingredients.

### 3. cross-contact

**Turn 6.** Cross-contact concerns unintended allergen introduction, which is not answered solely by the bun's intended ingredient list.

### 4. ingredient list

**Turn 8.** The ingredient list must match the actual bun in use, rather than an older menu or another supplied product.

### 5. handling information

**Turn 10.** Handling information covers preparation and service conditions, making it distinct from the list of intentional ingredients.

### 6. product specification

**Turn 12.** The product specification describes the supplied item; visual appearance alone is not equivalent to verified product information.

### 7. order hold

**Turn 14.** The order hold prevents this unresolved allergy query from being treated as an ordinary confirmed order ready for preparation.

### 8. ingredient verification

**Turn 16.** Ingredient verification is the actual check of the relevant product; receiving the question does not mean that check is complete.

### 9. alternative dish

**Turn 18.** An alternative dish is a separate option requiring appropriate checks, not an automatically safe replacement for the bun.

### 10. allergy flag

**Turn 20.** The allergy flag preserves the reported sesame allergy with the relevant order and handoff; it does not itself certify suitability.

Return to the conversation, page 32

# 03 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. What does Cam's availability establish?

**A. A kitchen lead can discuss the query.**

Availability provides a responsible contact, not a completed product or preparation assessment.

Return to the exercise, page 34

### F2. Which guest update is accurate?

**D. I cannot confirm suitability yet; the current information is being checked.**

The update preserves the unresolved status without offering a false guarantee or inventing a clinical event.

Return to the exercise, page 34

## F / Guided speaking

### 1. peanut

**Server:** The reported allergen is peanut.

**Turn 1.** Alex reports peanut, which must be repeated without changing the allergen.

### 2. sauce

**Colleague:** The product being questioned is the sauce.

**Turn 2.** The inquiry concerns the sauce, not an invented bread or dessert.

### 3. Imani

**Server:** The receiving kitchen lead is Imani.

**Turn 3.** Imani explicitly accepts the query as the named kitchen lead.

### 4. confirmed

**Colleague:** Suitability is not yet confirmed.

**Turn 4.** Neither current ingredients nor handling has been verified in this exchange.

Return to the conversation, page 35

# 03 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Checking the bun before ordering". Eli: "I will wait. Please do not bring me a different dish in the meantime; I need to choose after the check." Noor: [missing response] Eli: "Has the kitchen actually checked the bun yet, or are they still finding the information?" Which response belongs in the gap?**

**B. Understood. The order hold remains in place. Any alternative would need its own appropriate checks and your agreement before we proceed.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Eli says: "Thank you. I also do not want anyone to remove visible seeds and assume that has answered the question. The bread itself matters." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Noor's response in turn 14. It connects Eli's preceding point with Eli's follow-up. The order hold prevents this unresolved allergy query from being treated as an ordinary confirmed order ready for preparation.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Eli says: "Good. Please ask about preparation as well. I have had to be careful with shared equipment at other restaurants." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 18, after Eli says: "If the bun does not work for me, could we discuss another option afterward? I have not picked one yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 35

# 04 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. When were the mains fired?

**D. 7:20**

The kitchen began the relevant preparation stage at the stated 7:20 time.

Return to the exercise, page 36

### A2. What is the current estimate at 7:30?

**B. Another eight minutes**

The estimate is eight additional minutes from the 7:30 update.

Return to the exercise, page 36

### A3. What is the guests' departure requirement?

**C. Leave at 7:50**

The guests explicitly need to leave at 7:50.

Return to the exercise, page 36

## D / Response choices

### D1. Which timing explanation is accurate?

**B. At 7:30 the kitchen estimates eight more minutes, pointing to around 7:38.**

The explanation anchors the additional eight minutes to the current update and retains uncertainty.

Return to the exercise, page 40

### D2. What does 7:50 minus 7:38 establish?

**D. A twelve-minute clock interval, not guaranteed dining time**

Arithmetic alone does not establish delivery, eating, payment, or a comfortable departure.

Return to the exercise, page 40

# 04 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Kitchen area where finished dishes are checked and handed to service staff. Which term fits?

**C. pass**

**A Not here.** remaining time: Additional duration expected from the current update. The usual combination is "state the remaining time".

**B Not here.** update point: Agreed occasion for communicating the next status. The usual combination is "agree an update point".

**C Correct.** pass: Kitchen area where finished dishes are checked and handed to service staff. The usual combination is "collect from the pass".

**D Not here.** bottleneck: Step limiting the progress of the overall process. The usual combination is "identify the bottleneck".

Return to the exercise, page 40

### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "When did they start preparing them? We are not upset with you, but we do need to know where we stand." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "All right. If they are ready around seven thirty-eight, that leaves twelve minutes before we have to go. That sounds rather tight for us." Which response belongs in the gap?

**C. The fired time was seven twenty. In our kitchen language, that is when the mains were called for preparation. It does not mean they were ready or served then.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 14, after Riley says: "Please check. We would rather hear what is possible now than sit here hoping the food will arrive." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Riley says: "Would it be quicker to change one of the dishes? I do not want to cancel the whole meal if a realistic option is available." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Correct.** This is Tomas's response in turn 6. It connects Riley's preceding point with Riley's follow-up. The fired time records the preparation instruction at seven twenty; it is distinct from the later readiness estimate.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Riley says: "Could you check our mains, please? We have finished the starters, and we need to leave at seven fifty. I am beginning to worry about the time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 40

## E / Conversation

### 1. readiness estimate

**Turn 2.** The readiness estimate is provisional information about food readiness, not a promise that the whole meal will finish on time.

# 04 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. remaining time

**Turn 4.** Remaining time means additional time from the seven-thirty update, not total time since preparation began.

### 3. fired time

**Turn 6.** The fired time records the preparation instruction at seven twenty; it is distinct from the later readiness estimate.

### 4. departure deadline

**Turn 8.** The departure deadline is seven fifty, which must be considered separately from preparation or service estimates.

### 5. rush request

**Turn 10.** A rush request asks for acceleration; it does not establish accepted priority or a faster confirmed completion time.

### 6. timing discussion

**Turn 12.** A timing discussion explores feasible options without claiming that a substitute or cancellation has already been approved.

### 7. table update

**Turn 14.** A table update should communicate the actual order status and options, not repeat reassurance unsupported by the kitchen.

### 8. Pickup

**Turn 16.** Pickup is the kitchen-to-service handoff, which remains distinct from delivery to the table and completion of the meal.

### 9. timing constraint

**Turn 18.** The timing constraint remains the guests' seven-fifty departure; an uncertain kitchen estimate does not remove it.

### 10. completion promise

**Turn 20.** A completion promise would commit to a finished outcome; the available estimate does not justify such a guarantee.

Return to the conversation, page 42

# 04 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. Which offer stays within the facts?

**A. I can discuss the timing options with you and the kitchen.**

A timing discussion is available without inventing an approved operational or financial change.

Return to the exercise, page 44

### F2. Which phrase needs translation for a guest?

**B. Your mains were fired at 7:20.**

Fired is internal kitchen shorthand and may need a plain-language explanation of the preparation stage.

Return to the exercise, page 44

## F / Guided speaking

### 1. 8:10

**Server:** The estimate starts from 8:10.

**Turn 1.** The additional six minutes is anchored to the 8:10 update.

### 2. 8:16

**Guest:** That points to around 8:16.

**Turn 2.** Adding six minutes to 8:10 produces the approximate 8:16 time.

### 3. 8:30

**Server:** Your departure requirement is 8:30.

**Turn 3.** The supplied deadline is departure at 8:30, not food readiness.

### 4. unconfirmed

**Guest:** A faster alternative remains unconfirmed.

**Turn 4.** No quicker option has been confirmed in this scenario.

Return to the conversation, page 45

# 04 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "Please check. We would rather hear what is possible now than sit here hoping the food will arrive." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "Does that time mean ready in the kitchen or actually at our table? We will still need time to eat and pay." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A. Understood. My next table update should tell you what the kitchen can confirm and what remains uncertain. We should also agree when you will hear from me again.**

**A Correct.** This is Tomas's response in turn 14. It connects Riley's preceding point with Riley's follow-up. A table update should communicate the actual order status and options, not repeat reassurance unsupported by the kitchen.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Riley says: "Could you check our mains, please? We have finished the starters, and we need to leave at seven fifty. I am beginning to worry about the time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Riley says: "Another eight minutes from now? I thought the mains had gone in earlier. I am trying to work out whether we can stay." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 6, after Riley says: "When did they start preparing them? We are not upset with you, but we do need to know where we stand." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 45

# 05 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. What does the ticket confirm?

**B. Vegetable pasta**

The ticket supports the guest's vegetable-pasta order rather than the dish delivered.

Return to the exercise, page 48

### A2. What replacement can Dana offer?

**B. A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait**

The kitchen offers the pasta remake, with its timing stated as an estimate.

Return to the exercise, page 48

### A3. Who must review a bill adjustment?

**B. The shift lead**

The case assigns bill-adjustment review to the shift lead.

Return to the exercise, page 48

## D / Response choices

### D1. Which apology fits the facts?

**A. I am sorry; the ticket confirms pasta, but we brought risotto.**

The apology acknowledges the confirmed mismatch without blaming the guest or inventing a cause.

Return to the exercise, page 52

### D2. Which offer is authorized?

**D. A pasta remake with an estimated ten-minute wait**

Dana may offer the remake, while timing remains estimated and billing requires review.

Return to the exercise, page 52

# 05 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Actions addressing a service failure and its effect on the guest. Which term fits?

**D. service recovery**

**A Not here.** shift lead: Person coordinating service decisions during a shift. The usual combination is "consult the shift lead".

**B Not here.** acceptance: Agreement to a proposed option. The usual combination is "confirm acceptance".

**C Not here.** ordered dish: Food the guest requested. The usual combination is "confirm the ordered dish".

**D Correct.** service recovery: Actions addressing a service failure and its effect on the guest. The usual combination is "manage service recovery".

Return to the exercise, page 52

### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Pasta ordered, risotto delivered". Alex: "Is that ten minutes from now? We have already waited for the first round, so I need a realistic idea before I decide." Dana: [missing response] Alex: "Will there be anything off the bill? I do not feel comfortable paying as though everything arrived correctly." Which response belongs in the gap?

**A. They have quoted an estimated wait of ten minutes. I cannot promise the exact arrival time, and I understand another wait disrupts your meal.**

**A Correct.** This is Dana's response in turn 6. It connects Alex's preceding point with Alex's follow-up. An estimated wait is approximate; Dana cannot turn the kitchen's estimate into a guaranteed arrival time.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Alex says: "Will there be anything off the bill? I do not feel comfortable paying as though everything arrived correctly." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Alex says: "I thought the replacement might be free. Are you saying you cannot promise that yet?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Alex says: "Was the order entered incorrectly? I heard you say the ticket has pasta on it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 52

## E / Conversation

### 1. mistake

**Turn 2.** The ticket confirms pasta but risotto arrived, so mistake acknowledges an established service error without assigning blame.

# 05 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. remake

**Turn 4.** A remake is a newly prepared corrected dish, here the vegetable pasta originally ordered.

### 3. estimated wait

**Turn 6.** An estimated wait is approximate; Dana cannot turn the kitchen's estimate into a guaranteed arrival time.

### 4. bill adjustment

**Turn 8.** A bill adjustment changes the charge and requires the shift lead's review under this case's stated authority.

### 5. complimentary

**Turn 10.** Complimentary means provided without charge; the offered remake has not been approved as free.

### 6. cause

**Turn 12.** Cause concerns how the delivery error happened; the correct ticket alone does not identify the responsible stage or person.

### 7. check back

**Turn 14.** Check back means return to verify the correction and update the guest if the timing changes.

### 8. go-ahead

**Turn 16.** The go-ahead is the guest's permission to proceed; Alex has expressly asked Dana not to start the remake yet.

### 9. shift lead

**Turn 18.** The shift lead reviews the charge question and can receive Alex's request for a direct conversation.

### 10. next step

**Turn 20.** The next step is the bill review and update; neither the financial decision nor Alex's remake choice is complete.

Return to the conversation, page 54

# 05 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. Which statement keeps the financial decision accurate?

**A. I will ask the shift lead to review the bill question.**

The supplied authority covers referral for review, not a completed adjustment or universal rule.

Return to the exercise, page 56

### F2. When can the issue be described as fully resolved?

**C. After the relevant agreed actions are actually completed and checked**

An apology and offer are steps toward resolution, not evidence that the correction and related decisions are complete.

Return to the exercise, page 56

## F / Guided speaking

### 1. lentil

**Server:** The ticket confirms lentil soup.

**Turn 1.** Lentil is the ordered soup confirmed by the ticket.

### 2. tomato

**Guest:** The delivered soup was tomato.

**Turn 2.** Tomato is the soup actually delivered in this scenario.

### 3. seven

**Server:** The estimated remake wait is seven minutes.

**Turn 3.** Seven minutes is the stated estimate, not a guaranteed arrival time.

### 4. Noor

**Guest:** The bill question goes to Noor.

**Turn 4.** Noor is named as the lead responsible for reviewing an adjustment.

Return to the conversation, page 57

# 05 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Pasta ordered, risotto delivered". Alex: "If I do take the pasta, will you make sure it is mine this time? I would rather not go through this again." Dana: [missing response] Alex: "Before I decide, could you speak to the lead about the bill? Please do not start the replacement yet." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**B. Yes. I will check back on the corrected dish and keep you updated if the kitchen's timing changes.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Alex says: "Can I still get the pasta? I had been looking forward to it, but I am worried the others will finish before mine arrives." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Dana's response in turn 14. It connects Alex's preceding point with Alex's follow-up. Check back means return to verify the correction and update the guest if the timing changes.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 18, after Alex says: "Thank you. Can the lead speak with me if there are questions? I would prefer to explain what the extra wait means for us." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 16, after Alex says: "Before I decide, could you speak to the lead about the bill? Please do not start the replacement yet." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 57

# 06 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. What is the stated bill total?

**A. $72 with all listed charges included**

The scenario supplies a seventy-two-dollar total with its listed charges already included.

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### A2. What does three ways need to clarify?

**A. Equal payments or separate checks by item**

The phrase can refer to different allocation methods even with three diners.

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### A3. What is each equal share?

**D. $24**

Seventy-two divided by three equals twenty-four dollars per equal share.

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## D / Response choices

### D1. Which first question resolves the ambiguity?

**B. Do you mean equal payments or separate checks by item?**

The question presents the two supported methods without guessing the group's intention.

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### D2. Which arithmetic is correct for equal shares?

**D. $72 divided by 3 is $24 each.**

Three times twenty-four equals the full seventy-two-dollar total.

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# 06 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Payment of one amount through multiple payments or payers. Which term fits?

**C. split payment**

**A Not here.** allocation method: Agreed way of dividing the total or items. The usual combination is "clarify the allocation method".

**B Not here.** rounding: Adjustment to an available monetary precision under the relevant method. The usual combination is "explain rounding".

**C Correct.** split payment: Payment of one amount through multiple payments or payers. The usual combination is "arrange a split payment".

**D Not here.** card terminal: Device used to submit a card payment. The usual combination is "present the card terminal".

Return to the exercise, page 62

### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "If someone wants to pay only for their own meal, can you do that too? We would need to sort out the shared starters." Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "We did share some food, so equal payments may be simpler for us. Let me confirm with the others before you enter anything." Which response belongs in the gap?

**D. Yes. That requires an item allocation. We would also need your agreement about shared items rather than assume an equal division of those.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Morgan says: "What would it come to if we divided it equally? We shared a couple of dishes, so that may be easiest." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 18, after Morgan says: "We will pay one at a time, then. Could you show each person the amount before they tap?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 20, after Morgan says: "Yes, twenty-four each. We are all agreed now. You can bring the terminal when you are ready." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Correct.** This is Jules's response in turn 6. It connects Morgan's preceding point with Morgan's follow-up. Item allocation assigns charges to the relevant diners; their amounts cannot be calculated from the diner count alone.

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## E / Conversation

### 1. equal shares

**Turn 2.** Equal shares divide the total into the same amount for each diner, unlike separate checks based on individual items.

# 06 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. bill total

**Turn 4.** The bill total is the stated seventy-two dollars, including all listed charges in this fictional scenario.

### 3. item allocation

**Turn 6.** Item allocation assigns charges to the relevant diners; their amounts cannot be calculated from the diner count alone.

### 4. allocation method

**Turn 8.** The allocation method is the group's agreed way of dividing the bill, which the server should not choose for them.

### 5. split payment

**Turn 10.** The split payment applies three agreed twenty-four-dollar payments to one seventy-two-dollar bill; it does not change the total.

### 6. card terminal

**Turn 12.** The card terminal displays the payment being submitted; checking its amount helps prevent an incorrect full-bill charge.

### 7. listed charge

**Turn 14.** A listed charge is already part of the supplied total; splitting the payment does not justify charging it a second time.

### 8. payment receipt

**Turn 16.** A payment receipt records an actual transaction; it should not be represented as proof of payment before processing occurs.

### 9. outstanding balance

**Turn 18.** The outstanding balance is what remains unpaid after actual recorded payments, not an amount inferred solely from the agreed split.

### 10. payment confirmation

**Turn 20.** Payment confirmation establishes the relevant completed transaction status, which remains separate from agreeing a payment plan.

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# 06 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. What is needed to calculate item-based checks?

**A. An agreed allocation of items and shared charges**

Item-based amounts depend on who is assigned each charge, not simply the diner count.

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### F2. What does confirmation of three equal payments establish?

**D. The intended allocation, not completed payment**

Agreeing the method precedes processing and does not prove that any payment has been completed.

Return to the exercise, page 66

## F / Guided speaking

### 1. equal

**Server:** You have chosen equal payments.

**Turn 1.** The diners explicitly choose equal payments rather than item-based checks.

### 2. twenty-four

**Guest:** Each share is twenty-four dollars.

**Turn 2.** Ninety-six divided by four equals twenty-four dollars per diner.

### 3. ninety-six

**Server:** The full total remains ninety-six dollars.

**Turn 3.** Changing the allocation does not change the stated ninety-six-dollar total.

### 4. processed

**Guest:** The payments are not yet processed.

**Turn 4.** The scenario confirms the method but supplies no completed payment.

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# 06 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "Does the seventy-two already include everything listed on this check? I just want to be sure we are dividing the final figure." Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "Could we each have a receipt for our own payment? Two of us need one for our records." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A. Correct. The listed charge amounts are included in the stated total. I will not invent an additional fee or assume a tip choice from this request.**

**A Correct.** This is Jules's response in turn 14. It connects Morgan's preceding point with Morgan's follow-up. A listed charge is already part of the supplied total; splitting the payment does not justify charging it a second time.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Morgan says: "They have agreed. We want three equal payments, not separate bills based on individual dishes. Twenty-four each sounds right to us." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Morgan says: "Could we split this three ways, please? There are three of us, and we would like to sort it out before everyone starts reaching for a card." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Morgan says: "Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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# 07 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. Why is the empty plate still needed?

**C. The diner is using it for another portion.**

The brief states that the diner will use the plate for more shared food.

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### A2. What remains in the shared dish?

**B. Vegetables**

The shared vegetable dish still contains food in this case.

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### A3. What may the team offer?

**B. Extra sharing plates**

Extra sharing plates are available to offer, while clearing still needs clarification.

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## D / Response choices

### D1. Which question is most appropriate?

**D. May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?**

The question checks the actual plate and allows the diner to keep using it.

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### D2. What does the empty plate establish?

**B. Its current contents, not that it is no longer needed**

The plate is empty but remains in use for another portion.

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# 07 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Colleague who carries prepared dishes to guests and may assist service. Which term fits?

**B. food runner**

**A Not here.** side plate: Small plate used for bread, sides, or another specified purpose. The usual combination is "offer a side plate".

**B Correct.** food runner: Colleague who carries prepared dishes to guests and may assist service. The usual combination is "brief the food runner".

**C Not here.** glassware: Drinking vessels made of glass. The usual combination is "collect finished glassware".

**D Not here.** table reset: Preparation of a cleared table for its next guests. The usual combination is "begin an authorized table reset".

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### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "An empty plate still in use". Leo: "What would you say without interrupting the conversation too much? I want the question to be clear but not sound as though I am trying to hurry them." Mina: [missing response] Leo: "If they say they are using it for more vegetables, I can simply say of course and leave it. I do not need them to justify it." Which response belongs in the gap?

**B. Ask for clearing permission briefly: May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then pause long enough for an answer.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 16, after Leo says: "Right. I will check the glass separately, not start taking the whole setting away while they still have food." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Mina's response in turn 6. It connects Leo's preceding point with Leo's follow-up. Clearing permission is the guest's agreement to remove the specific item, which should be obtained before taking it.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 20, after Leo says: "I will keep it brief at the table. May I clear this plate, or are you still using it? Then I wait for the answer." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Leo says: "I will keep the vegetables in place too. There is still food there, and no one has asked us to remove the dish." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 74

## E / Conversation

### 1. active item

**Turn 2.** The active item is the empty plate still needed for another portion; its empty surface does not make it finished.

# 07 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. service cue

**Turn 4.** A service cue may suggest a need, but the empty plate is ambiguous and requires checking with the guest.

### 3. clearing permission

**Turn 6.** Clearing permission is the guest's agreement to remove the specific item, which should be obtained before taking it.

### 4. guest preference

**Turn 8.** The guest preference is the actual table's request, not a rule inferred from nationality or an empty plate.

### 5. sharing plate

**Turn 10.** A sharing plate can help guests take portions from a shared dish, but the extra item remains an offer.

### 6. shared dish

**Turn 12.** The shared dish still contains vegetables for continued service, so one empty individual plate does not establish permission to remove it.

### 7. finished item

**Turn 14.** A finished item can be removed with appropriate agreement without treating the entire table as finished with the meal.

### 8. table reset

**Turn 16.** A table reset prepares the setting for new guests; clearing one agreed item during a meal is a different stage.

### 9. meal pace

**Turn 18.** Meal pace is the guests' eating rhythm, which the team can respect by checking needs instead of rushing active items away.

### 10. Unobtrusive service

**Turn 20.** Unobtrusive service meets the real need with minimal disruption, combining a specific question with respectful follow-through.

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# 07 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. Which instruction should Mina give Leo?

**C. Leave the active plate and ask what may be cleared.**

The instruction preserves active items while allowing a specific clearing-permission check.

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### F2. How should cultural differences be handled?

**D. Ask the individual table about its preference.**

A direct, respectful question establishes the actual preference without relying on group stereotypes.

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## F / Guided speaking

### 1. needed

**Server:** The empty plate is still needed.

**Turn 1.** The diner needs the plate for another portion of shared dessert.

### 2. dessert

**Colleague:** The shared dish contains dessert.

**Turn 2.** The remaining food in the supplied shared dish is dessert.

### 3. offered

**Server:** Extra small plates can be offered.

**Turn 3.** The plates are an available offer, not an automatic addition.

### 4. given

**Colleague:** Clearing permission has not been given.

**Turn 4.** The scenario supplies no guest permission to remove the active plate.

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# 07 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "An empty plate still in use". Leo: "If another guest has actually finished with a glass or plate, may I check that item separately? I do not want to leave everything unnecessarily." Mina: [missing response] Leo: "Right. I will check the glass separately, not start taking the whole setting away while they still have food." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**C. Yes. A finished item can be handled separately. Ask specifically, and keep the action narrow enough that we do not accidentally clear something another diner is using.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Leo says: "I see. They are sharing, so the empty plate is not finished with. I will leave it where it is." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Leo says: "We can offer extra plates as well, correct? That might make sharing easier, but I should not bring a stack of them without asking." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Correct.** This is Mina's response in turn 14. It connects Leo's preceding point with Leo's follow-up. A finished item can be removed with appropriate agreement without treating the entire table as finished with the meal.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Leo says: "If they say they are using it for more vegetables, I can simply say of course and leave it. I do not need them to justify it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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# 08 / Answers and explanations

## A / Read the situation

### A1. What is table 4's meal stage?

**C. Mains served; dessert not ordered**

The brief states that the mains are served while dessert remains unchosen.

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### A2. What is table 5's check status?

**B. Open**

Table 5 has an open check while the coffee query remains under review.

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### A3. Who is reviewing the possible duplicate coffee charge?

**C. The shift lead**

The shift lead is already reviewing the query, but no result is supplied.

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## D / Response choices

### D1. Which handover for table 4 is correct?

**C. Mains served; dessert not ordered; follow up the dessert choice.**

The message preserves the known meal stage and identifies the unfinished dessert follow-up.

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### D2. Which coffee description is justified?

**C. A possible duplicate charge under shift-lead review**

The brief supplies a pending query, not a confirmed error, motive, or adjustment.

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# 08 / Answers and explanations / continued

### D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Colleague accepting responsibility for the next service period. Which term fits?

**C. incoming server**

**A Not here.** dessert decision: Guest choice about whether and what dessert to order. The usual combination is "follow up the dessert decision".

**B Not here.** unresolved item: Task or question that has not been completed or answered. The usual combination is "track the unresolved item".

**C Correct.** incoming server: Colleague accepting responsibility for the next service period. The usual combination is "confirm the incoming server".

**D Not here.** service owner: Person responsible for the guest-facing follow-up. The usual combination is "name the service owner".

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### D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two tables, two unfinished tasks". Ben: "Exactly. Ask about dessert when they are ready. There is nothing on the dessert ticket to chase." Maya: [missing response] Ben: "Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question." Which response belongs in the gap?

**B. I will handle the dessert decision with table four. That is the first task I am accepting. What is happening at table five?**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 18, after Ben says: "Correct. Five is still open, and we have no approved adjustment. Please keep that separate from the fact you have taken the table." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Maya's response in turn 6. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. The dessert decision is the guest's pending choice; the incoming server should ask rather than treat it as an existing order.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Ben says: "Exactly. I have not been given a review result, and no bill adjustment has been approved. The guest needs an accurate update once there is a decision." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Ben says: "Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 85

## E / Conversation

### 1. handover

**Turn 2.** The handover transfers relevant table information and accepted responsibility, not just a list of numbers.

# 08 / Answers and explanations / continued

### 2. mains served

**Turn 4.** Mains served means the main dishes have reached table four; it does not establish that dessert has been ordered.

### 3. dessert decision

**Turn 6.** The dessert decision is the guest's pending choice; the incoming server should ask rather than treat it as an existing order.

### 4. open check

**Turn 8.** The open check remains unsettled in the relevant process; the handover does not supply payment or closure.

### 5. suspected duplicate

**Turn 10.** A suspected duplicate is a possible repeated charge under review, not a confirmed error or approved adjustment.

### 6. service owner

**Turn 12.** The service owner takes responsibility for guest-facing follow-up while the shift lead remains responsible for the charge decision.

### 7. exception note

**Turn 14.** The exception note preserves the unusual unresolved coffee query alongside the table's ordinary service and payment status.

### 8. read-back confirmation

**Turn 16.** Read-back confirmation checks that the receiving server has matched each table with the correct unfinished task.

### 9. status change

**Turn 18.** A status change must reflect an actual new event or decision, not an assumption caused by the handover.

### 10. continuity of service

**Turn 20.** Continuity of service keeps guest needs attended to across the staffing change without losing unresolved work.

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# 08 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Accuracy and scope

### F1. Which ownership arrangement is clear?

**C. Maya accepts guest follow-up while the shift lead reviews the charge.**

The arrangement distinguishes guest communication from the decision authority and gives both work streams an owner.

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### F2. What must precede calling table 5's check closed?

**A. The actual relevant payment and closure process**

A staffing handover does not establish that the bill has been paid or closed.

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## F / Guided speaking

### 1. dessert

**Outgoing server:** Table 8 needs a dessert follow-up.

**Turn 1.** Dessert is not ordered, so Noor needs to check that choice.

### 2. open

**Incoming server:** Table 9's check remains open.

**Turn 2.** No payment or closure is established for table nine.

### 3. tea

**Outgoing server:** The queried item is tea.

**Turn 3.** The possible duplicate concerns tea rather than an invented coffee charge.

### 4. Noor

**Incoming server:** The receiving server is Noor.

**Turn 4.** Noor explicitly accepts both follow-ups in this handover.

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# 08 / Answers and explanations / continued

## F / Rebuild the exchange

**1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two tables, two unfinished tasks". Ben: "That is the distinction. Please keep the unresolved question visible in the notes as well, so it does not disappear when the section assignment changes." Maya: [missing response] Ben: "Can you read back both tasks once more? I want to be sure I have not mixed the table numbers while we are moving between them." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**B. I will retain the exception note and the current status. A change of server should not make a pending charge question look like routine payment completed.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Ben says: "Table four has received its mains. Dessert has not been ordered, so please check their choice when it is appropriate in the service." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Maya's response in turn 14. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. The exception note preserves the unusual unresolved coffee query alongside the table's ordinary service and payment status.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Ben says: "The lead has the bill question. Can you check for the answer and keep table five updated after I leave?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Ben says: "Maya, it is eight o'clock. I need to hand over tables four and five before I leave the section. Each has a different follow-up still open." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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# Review 1 / Explanations

## Cumulative review

### 1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Identifier used to locate a dining table. Which term fits?

**D. table number**

**A Not here.** preference: Stated choice that must not automatically be labeled a medical condition. The usual combination is "record a preference".

**B Not here.** omission: Requested removal of an ingredient or component. The usual combination is "confirm the omission".

**C Not here.** main: Principal dish in a meal. The usual combination is "choose a main".

**D Correct.** table number: Identifier used to locate a dining table. The usual combination is "check the table number".

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### 2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Amount separating two prices on a comparable basis. Which term fits?

**D. price difference**

**A Not here.** set menu: Group of included courses offered for a stated price, subject to listed conditions. The usual combination is "explain the set menu".

**B Not here.** portion: Amount served to one person or as specified. The usual combination is "describe the portion".

**C Not here.** price clarification: Explanation resolving uncertainty about what an amount means. The usual combination is "give a price clarification".

**D Correct.** price difference: Amount separating two prices on a comparable basis. The usual combination is "calculate the price difference".

Return to the exercise, page 24

# Review 1 / Explanations / continued

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "Who asked for no onions?". Lena: "Correct. The salad has both requests. I originally wrote them between the items because two people were speaking at once." Cam: [missing response] Lena: "I have not sent anything yet. I wanted to settle the unclear detail first rather than ask the kitchen to interpret my note." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**C. Now the seat reference makes the connection clear. Keep the requests attached to that item in the system too.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Lena says: "It belongs to the salad, not the pasta. Sam also wants the dressing separately. I have corrected the note against seat two." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 6, after Lena says: "Mushroom pasta, unchanged. Seat three was still looking at the menu when I came over, so I have left that choice open." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Correct.** This is Cam's response in turn 10. It connects Lena's preceding point with Lena's follow-up. The seat reference attaches both salad requests to seat two and leaves seat one's pasta unchanged.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 18, after Lena says: "I will return to seat three now and ask what they would like. Then I can repeat the complete order to the table." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

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**4. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "Thanks. I will leave coffee for now. Could you repeat just the two steak prices for me?" Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Let me check with my friend about dessert before I decide. I have not chosen the set yet." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A. Then the price basis is twenty-nine for steak, potatoes, and the included dessert, or twenty-seven for steak and potatoes without dessert.**

**A Correct.** This is Priya's response in turn 18. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. The price basis specifies what each quoted amount covers, avoiding unsupported claims about other items or charges.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Jordan says: "Good, I was about to ask about the potatoes. I do not want to discover I need to order a side as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Jordan says: "Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Jordan says: "So the steak is five dollars extra on the set? I first read that as a separate price, which did not seem right." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

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# Review 2 / Explanations

## Cumulative review

### 1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Seed recognized among the major food allergens in the United States. Which term fits?

**A. sesame**

**A Correct.** sesame: Seed recognized among the major food allergens in the United States. The usual combination is "flag a sesame allergy".

**B Not here.** cross-contact: Unintended introduction of an allergen into another food. The usual combination is "assess allergen cross-contact".

**C Not here.** product substitution: Use of a different supplied item in place of the usual one. The usual combination is "check for a product substitution".

**D Not here.** unsupported assurance: Reassuring claim without adequate information or authority. The usual combination is "avoid an unsupported assurance".

Return to the exercise, page 46

### 2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Approximate expectation for when food will be ready at the stated stage. Which term fits?

**C. readiness estimate**

**A Not here.** table update: Information given to guests about their order or service. The usual combination is "deliver a table update".

**B Not here.** fire: Kitchen instruction to begin or advance preparation at the required service stage. The usual combination is "fire the mains".

**C Correct.** readiness estimate: Approximate expectation for when food will be ready at the stated stage. The usual combination is "give a readiness estimate".

**D Not here.** on the fly: Urgent preparation request in restaurant shorthand, not a guarantee of instant service. The usual combination is "request a dish on the fly".

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# Review 2 / Explanations / continued

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "The steak set or steak alone?". Jordan: "Then the set is two dollars more than the steak alone. I am not especially hungry, so I am deciding whether I want dessert." Priya: [missing response] Jordan: "Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?" Which response belongs in the gap?**

**B. That is the correct price difference. If you want the included dessert, the set is twenty-nine. If not, the steak alone is twenty-seven.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Jordan says: "Good, I was about to ask about the potatoes. I do not want to discover I need to order a side as well." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Correct.** This is Priya's response in turn 10. It connects Jordan's preceding point with Jordan's follow-up. The price difference is twenty-nine minus twenty-seven, or two dollars between these two specific options.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Jordan says: "Could you help me with the lunch menu? I saw twenty-four dollars beside the set, but there is another amount beside the steak." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Jordan says: "Could I order the steak alone and add dessert for two dollars later, or does that price only work with the set?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "Thank you. We still need to leave at seven fifty, even if the food is delayed. That is the constraint we need you to work with." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "Thank you. Please check before changing anything. We still have the original order for now." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A. I will carry that timing constraint into the conversation. I will not represent your departure as flexible or assume you can stay longer.**

**A Correct.** This is Tomas's response in turn 18. It connects Riley's preceding point with Riley's follow-up. The timing constraint remains the guests' seven-fifty departure; an uncertain kitchen estimate does not remove it.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Riley says: "Can you move our order ahead of everyone else? I realize the kitchen is busy, but we cannot miss the event we are going to." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Riley says: "Another eight minutes from now? I thought the mains had gone in earlier. I am trying to work out whether we can stay." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 20, after Riley says: "Thank you. Please check before changing anything. We still have the original order for now." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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# Review 3 / Explanations

## Cumulative review

### 1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Proposed substitute or corrected item that the guest may accept. Which term fits?

**C. replacement offer**

**A Not here.** estimated wait: Approximate expected delay before a specified next event. The usual combination is "explain the estimated wait".

**B Not here.** delivered dish: Food actually brought to the guest. The usual combination is "identify the delivered dish".

**C Correct.** replacement offer: Proposed substitute or corrected item that the guest may accept. The usual combination is "explain the replacement offer".

**D Not here.** void: Cancellation of a transaction or entry through the relevant system procedure. The usual combination is "record an authorized void".

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### 2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Dish or charge used by more than one diner. Which term fits?

**A. shared item**

**A Correct.** shared item: Dish or charge used by more than one diner. The usual combination is "allocate a shared item".

**B Not here.** partial payment: Payment of less than the full amount due. The usual combination is "record a partial payment".

**C Not here.** gratuity: Usually a tip; an automatic mandatory charge may instead be a service charge under applicable rules. The usual combination is "clarify a gratuity".

**D Not here.** check: Restaurant bill listing the guest's charges. The usual combination is "bring the check".

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# Review 3 / Explanations / continued

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "Eight more minutes?". Riley: "Can you move our order ahead of everyone else? I realize the kitchen is busy, but we cannot miss the event we are going to." Tomas: [missing response] Riley: "Would it be quicker to change one of the dishes? I do not want to cancel the whole meal if a realistic option is available." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**C. I can discuss a rush request with the kitchen. I cannot promise a different position or faster completion before they confirm what is actually possible.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 16, after Riley says: "Does that time mean ready in the kitchen or actually at our table? We will still need time to eat and pay." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Riley says: "Another eight minutes from now? I thought the mains had gone in earlier. I am trying to work out whether we can stay." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Correct.** This is Tomas's response in turn 10. It connects Riley's preceding point with Riley's follow-up. A rush request asks for acceleration; it does not establish accepted priority or a faster confirmed completion time.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 20, after Riley says: "Thank you. Please check before changing anything. We still have the original order for now." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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---

**4. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "We will pay one at a time, then. Could you show each person the amount before they tap?" Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "Yes, twenty-four each. We are all agreed now. You can bring the terminal when you are ready." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**A. Yes. The outstanding balance must reflect the actual payments recorded. Three agreed amounts are not a substitute for checking which transactions have completed.**

**A Correct.** This is Jules's response in turn 18. It connects Morgan's preceding point with Morgan's follow-up. The outstanding balance is what remains unpaid after actual recorded payments, not an amount inferred solely from the agreed split.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 20, after Morgan says: "Yes, twenty-four each. We are all agreed now. You can bring the terminal when you are ready." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Not here.** This line belongs to turn 4, after Morgan says: "What would it come to if we divided it equally? We shared a couple of dishes, so that may be easiest." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 6, after Morgan says: "If someone wants to pay only for their own meal, can you do that too? We would need to sort out the shared starters." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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---

# Review 4 / Explanations

## Cumulative review

### 1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Team member who supports clearing, resetting, and related dining-room tasks. Which term fits?

**D. busser**

**A Not here.** meal pace: Speed and rhythm at which guests are eating. The usual combination is "respect the meal pace".

**B Not here.** crockery: Plates, bowls, and other ceramic dining vessels. The usual combination is "handle the crockery".

**C Not here.** place setting: Arrangement of dining items for one person. The usual combination is "maintain the place setting".

**D Correct.** busser: Team member who supports clearing, resetting, and related dining-room tasks. The usual combination is "coordinate with the busser".

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### 2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Status indicating main dishes have reached the guests. Which term fits?

**D. mains served**

**A Not here.** status change: Actual transition from one confirmed state to another. The usual combination is "communicate a status change".

**B Not here.** charge review: Examination of whether a billed amount is correct. The usual combination is "request a charge review".

**C Not here.** section: Group of tables assigned to a server or service team. The usual combination is "take over a section".

**D Correct.** mains served: Status indicating main dishes have reached the guests. The usual combination is "confirm mains served".

Return to the exercise, page 91

# Review 4 / Explanations / continued

**3. Rebuild the exchange from "What does three ways mean?". Morgan: "They have agreed. We want three equal payments, not separate bills based on individual dishes. Twenty-four each sounds right to us." Jules: [missing response] Morgan: "Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**C. Thank you. I will arrange the split payment as three payments of twenty-four dollars against the seventy-two-dollar total. Please confirm that is the method you want.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 2, after Morgan says: "Could we split this three ways, please? There are three of us, and we would like to sort it out before everyone starts reaching for a card." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 14, after Morgan says: "Does the seventy-two already include everything listed on this check? I just want to be sure we are dividing the final figure." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Correct.** This is Jules's response in turn 10. It connects Morgan's preceding point with Morgan's follow-up. The split payment applies three agreed twenty-four-dollar payments to one seventy-two-dollar bill; it does not change the total.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 12, after Morgan says: "Yes, that is correct. I want to make sure the number on the terminal will match that amount, not the whole seventy-two dollars." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

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**4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two tables, two unfinished tasks". Ben: "Correct. Five is still open, and we have no approved adjustment. Please keep that separate from the fact you have taken the table." Maya: [missing response] Ben: "Good. You have both follow-ups, and the shift lead still has the charge decision. That gives each next step a clear person to contact." Which response belongs in the gap?**

**C. Agreed. Any status change will reflect what actually occurs. Accepted follow-up is not the same as completed service, approved adjustment, or settled payment.**

**A Not here.** This line belongs to turn 10, after Ben says: "Exactly. I have not been given a review result, and no bill adjustment has been approved. The guest needs an accurate update once there is a decision." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**B Not here.** This line belongs to turn 6, after Ben says: "Exactly. Ask about dessert when they are ready. There is nothing on the dessert ticket to chase." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

**C Correct.** This is Maya's response in turn 18. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. A status change must reflect an actual new event or decision, not an assumption caused by the handover.

**D Not here.** This line belongs to turn 8, after Ben says: "Table five still has an open check. They asked about what may be a duplicate coffee charge, and the shift lead is reviewing that question." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 91

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# Additional case 1 / Explanations

## Extended conversation

### 1. committed portions

**Turn 2.** Three of the four physical portions already belong to accepted tickets, leaving only one for a new order.

### 2. 86 list

**Turn 4.** The 86 list identifies items unavailable for further orders; it does not cancel portions already committed to accepted tickets.

### 3. substitution

**Turn 8.** The substitution replaces seat two's requested salmon with the pasta that the guest actually selected.

### 4. price difference

**Turn 10.** Two salmon would total $52; one $26 salmon plus $21 pasta totals $47, a $5 difference for these mains.

### 5. replacement choice

**Turn 13.** Seat two explicitly chose mushroom pasta after the shortage and price were explained; it is not a kitchen-selected substitute.

### 6. availability update

**Turn 17.** The availability update must communicate that no further salmon orders can be accepted; existing committed orders remain distinct.

Return to the conversation, page 94

## Transfer exchange

### 1. two

**Server:** There are two portions available before the new choices.

**Turn 1.** Six physical portions minus four already committed leaves two available to allocate.

# Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

### 2. chicken

**Expeditor:** The third guest has agreed to chicken .

**Turn 2.** The replacement is explicitly chosen chicken, not a substitute selected without permission.

### 3. 80

**Server:** These three mains total 80 dollars.

**Turn 3.** Two sea-bass mains at $28 plus chicken at $24 equals $80.

### 4. unavailable

**Expeditor:** After allocation, sea bass is unavailable for further orders.

**Turn 4.** All six physical portions are now committed; physical presence does not mean they remain available to sell.

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# Additional case 2 / Explanations

## Extended conversation

### 1. service charge

**Turn 2.** The $27 service charge is mandatory under this fictional restaurant's disclosed terms, unlike an additional voluntary tip.

### 2. subtotal

**Turn 4.** The stated $150 food-and-drinks subtotal is the basis for this charge; the example does not apply eighteen percent to the final total.

### 3. amount due

**Turn 6.** The supplied amounts sum to $189 before a voluntary extra tip; the already listed tax and service charge must not be added again.

### 4. additional gratuity

**Turn 8.** An additional gratuity is a voluntary extra amount; selecting zero there does not remove the existing mandatory service charge.

### 5. distribution policy

**Turn 12.** The case supplies no policy explaining how the service charge is distributed; Alma must not invent a staff share.

### 6. listed tax

**Turn 16.** The case supplies a $12 tax line, not a universal rate or rule about which charges are taxable.

Return to the conversation, page 99

## Transfer exchange

### 1. 12

**Guest:** The service charge is 12 dollars.

**Turn 1.** Fifteen percent of the $80 subtotal is $12, not fifteen percent of the final total.

# Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

### 2. 98

**Server:** The total before any extra tip is 98 dollars.

**Turn 2.** The $80 subtotal plus $12 service charge plus $6 listed tax equals $98.

### 3. zero

**Guest:** My additional tip choice is zero .

**Turn 3.** The guest explicitly chooses no extra tip; that does not cancel the mandatory service charge.

### 4. unspecified

**Server:** The staff-distribution policy remains unspecified .

**Turn 4.** The check's arithmetic gives no evidence of what proportion is paid to staff.

Return to the conversation, page 101

# Additional case 3 / Explanations

## Extended conversation

### 1. format

**Turn 2.** Format describes how the menu information is presented; Theo asks what works instead of assuming the phone or print is accessible.

### 2. Parmesan

**Turn 4.** Parmesan is the explicitly listed risotto ingredient; omitting it would withhold relevant menu information from Rosa.

### 3. chickpea stew

**Turn 6.** Chickpea stew is the second listed main, priced at $20 and served with bread.

### 4. choice

**Turn 8.** Rosa explicitly selects the stew with its bread; Theo confirms the guest's own decision rather than choosing for her.

### 5. read back

**Turn 12.** Read back means repeat the selected order aloud so Rosa can check it without depending on the printed menu.

### 6. itemized bill

**Turn 16.** An itemized bill separates the ordered items and listed charges; reading it lets Rosa review the bill herself.

Return to the conversation, page 103

## Transfer exchange

### 1. 8

**Server:** The crumble costs 8 dollars.

**Turn 1.** Eight dollars is the stated crumble price, not the price of the sorbet.

# Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

### 2. ice cream

**Guest:** The crumble comes with vanilla ice cream .

**Turn 2.** Vanilla ice cream is a listed accompaniment that should not be omitted from the spoken description.

### 3. sorbet

**Server:** Your chosen dessert is mango sorbet .

**Turn 3.** Jo selects sorbet; assistance with reading does not transfer the choice to the server.

### 4. 7

**Guest:** Its menu price is 7 dollars.

**Turn 4.** The sorbet's stated menu price is $7; the facts do not establish the final bill total.

Return to the conversation, page 105

# Find a phrase by purpose

## Confirming seats and order details

**Clarify the dish:** Which dish should have no onions?

**Check the guest:** Is that request for your salad?

**Read back seat one:** Seat one is the mushroom pasta.

Full phrase bank, page 7

## Explaining menu choices and prices

**Introduce the set:** The lunch set includes a main and dessert.

**State the base:** The set starts at $24.

**Explain the addition:** Steak carries a $5 supplement on that set.

Full phrase bank, page 17

## Receiving an allergy question

**Acknowledge the disclosure:** Thank you for telling me about the sesame allergy.

**Repeat the allergen:** I have heard sesame; is that correct?

**State the information limit:** This old description does not verify today's bun.

Full phrase bank, page 29

## Coordinating courses and delays

**Acknowledge the wait:** I am sorry your mains are taking longer than you expected.

**Give the current update:** At 7:30, the kitchen estimates another eight minutes.

**Name the remaining work:** One dish is still being prepared.

Full phrase bank, page 39

# Find a phrase by purpose / continued

## Correcting a dish without blame

**Acknowledge the mismatch:** You ordered vegetable pasta, and we brought mushroom risotto.

**Apologize directly:** I am sorry; that is not the dish you ordered.

**Refer to the record:** I checked the ticket, and it confirms the pasta.

Full phrase bank, page 51

## Explaining and splitting a bill

**Clarify the request:** Do you mean three equal payments or separate checks by item?

**State the total:** The bill total is $72.

**Explain equal shares:** Three equal shares would be $24 each.

Full phrase bank, page 61

## Agreeing on clearing and shared service

**Ask about an item:** May I clear this plate, or are you still using it?

**Accept continued use:** Of course; I will leave it for your next portion.

**Check the shared dish:** Would you like the vegetables to stay on the table?

Full phrase bank, page 73

## Handing over a live section

**Open the transfer:** It is 8:00, and I am handing over tables 4 and 5.

**State table 4's stage:** Table 4 has its mains.

**Keep dessert accurate:** Dessert has not been ordered.

Full phrase bank, page 84

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# References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.


### [1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Waiters and Waitresses.

Occupational context for order-taking, kitchen communication, guest service, clearing, and payment work. The original cases do not represent employment statistics. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.bls.gov/ooh/food-preparation-and-serving/waiters-and-waitresses.htm

### [2] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Allergies.

Background for allergen and cross-contact terminology. The allergy dialogue never certifies a dish or substitutes for current ingredient and preparation checks. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.fda.gov/food/nutrition-food-labeling-and-critical-foods/food-allergies?lv=true

### [3] US Food and Drug Administration. Food Code 2026.

A model food code offered for jurisdictional adoption, not an automatically universal restaurant rule. Consult applicable current local requirements. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.fda.gov/food/fda-food-code/food-code-2026



**Companion course**

The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.

https://englishladder.com/efsp-restaurant-servers.html

# Clear orders. Confident service.

Eight lessons on orders, menu choices, allergies, delays, corrections, payment, shared service, and section handovers. Three additional conversations cover availability, service charges, and accessible ordering.

### Confirming seats and order details

No onions needs a clear dish reference. Do not attach it to every plate because the speaker was unclear. A modifier describes the requested change; a reported allergy requires its own accurate communication and the actual allergy process.

### Explaining menu choices and prices

The $5 supplement belongs to the $24 set base: $24 + $5 = $29. It is not added to the $27 a la carte price. The comparison is $29 with dessert versus $27 without dessert, with potatoes in both.

### Receiving an allergy question

A plain-looking bun is not an ingredient list. Ingredient information and cross-contact information answer related but different questions. Removing visible seeds does not establish suitability. An old menu description cannot certify the actual product being prepared today.

### Coordinating courses and delays

Eight more minutes at 7:30 points to approximately 7:38 for the stated readiness estimate. It is not eight minutes from 7:20. Readiness, delivery to the table, eating, payment, and departure are separate events.

---

## Phil Stilwell

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